

Global Hotels & Leisure

Global Lodging: World Cup boost covers softness elsewhere



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The headline grabbing numbers at Q2 look set to be in US RevPAR. US RevPAR rose 4% across April–May, accelerating to 7% in the first week of June. That week included just eight World Cup matches versus 28 and 36 in the following two weeks. Even without further acceleration, the World Cup boost should push hotel groups to the top end of guidance - or better; Hyatt should lead. US strength more than offsets well-flagged Middle East weakness and slower growth in Europe and China. OTA traffic has softened into Q2, particularly at Booking and Expedia. However, Booking consensus has fallen to 3.5% room night growth (vs. 2–4% guidance); unless cancellations remain elevated, this looks beatable, with ~6.5% achievable. Airbnb looks cleaner, with stronger web and download trends driven more by APAC/LatAm than the World Cup; we expect ~10% night growth, a 1.6% beat to consensus. Expedia looks a bigger concern, and looks to need a big B2B quarter to avoid a miss to consensus.

OTA demand. App traffic growth has slowed across all three major platforms. Web trends are mixed: deterioration at BKNG and EXPE, but resilience at ABNB, driving LDD y/y growth. Agoda remains strong (~30% app engagement growth), while Booking and Priceline lag. At EXPE, Expedia and Hotels.com face y/y declines, while Vrbo performs well. Overall, Airbnb should deliver the cleanest quarter (~10% growth), while Booking (~6.5%) can still beat a low guide and conservative consensus.

AI showing early signs of an inflection? Referral data shows that traffic being directed to the OTAs by AI has returned to growth this quarter, having slowly been in decline since Q3 last year. Despite this inflection, AI referrals still contribute <0.5% of total traffic. We still await the launch of Google's AI-mode hotel feature which is expected to leverage Google's suite of AI protocols (Universal Commerce, Model Context, Agentic Payments) to facilitate booking without visiting a brand website or OTA.

Hotel demand: Q2 marks the start of the World Cup effect, which looks positive against muted expectations given strong June run rates (~4%) and easy comps. North American strength should push RevPAR to or above the top end of guidance despite international softness. The K-shape persists, with luxury outperforming: Hyatt (4.3%), Marriott (3.2%), Hilton (2.9%), IHG (2.6%), the latter weighed down by a slower quarter in China.

Development remains resilient in the face of conflict in the Middle East. The hotel pipeline continues a steady recovery from last year's Liberation day contraction, showing no signs of being impacted by the conflict in the Middle East. The global pipeline is now ~48,000 rooms (1.9%) larger than pre-Liberation day levels, with all regions contributing to this recovery. Construction has been even stronger, with ~54,500 (6.1%) more rooms in construction in May than at the end of 2025. MEA has been resilient given the conflict in the region, with the pipeline 3.5% larger than it was in February and in construction rooms continuing to increase. With the conflict in Iran now in its fourth month, the inflationary pressure of building material prices and fuel are yet to have a meaningful impact on global development.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	18 Jun 2026		Price Target	TTM Rel. Perf.	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
		Cur	Closing Price			Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
BKNG (Booking)	M	USD	171.78	188.00	(44.4)%	USD	9.12	10.53	12.29	18.8	16.3	14.0
ABNB (Airbnb)	O	USD	142.41	168.00	(17.9)%	USD	4.03	5.44	6.65	35.3	26.2	21.4
EXPE (Expedia)	M	USD	240.90	253.00	22.6%	USD	15.86	20.92	25.20	15.2	11.5	9.6
TRIP (TripAdvisor)	O	USD	12.97	20.00	(26.3)%	USD	1.27	1.30	1.88	10.2	10.0	6.9
HLT (Hilton)	M	USD	348.84	320.00	15.2%	USD	8.11	8.96	10.28	43.0	38.9	33.9
MAR (Marriott)	O	USD	396.20	402.00	28.2%	USD	10.02	11.53	13.30	39.5	34.4	29.8
IHG.LN (IHG)	M	USD	171.20	154.00	37.0%	USD	5.01	5.69	6.48	34.2	30.1	26.4
H (Hyatt)	O	USD	202.09	202.00	26.8%	USD	2.25	4.03	5.17	89.7	50.1	39.1
AC.FP (Accor)	O	EUR	48.86	55.70	(1.0)%	EUR	1.86	2.25	2.73	26.3	21.8	17.9
SPX			7,500.58									
EDME			1,578.06									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

In lodging, we rate Marriott, Accor and Hyatt Outperform, and IHG and Hilton Market-Perform. In online travel, we rate Airbnb and Tripadvisor Outperform, and Booking and Expedia Market-Perform.

Recent research on OTAs:

[Tripadvisor: TheFork sale agreed with American Express for \\$700m \(49% of market cap\)](#)

[Booking: How it won online travel & can it win AI travel?](#)

[Airbnb: Bernstein SDC best ideas slides & key take aways from investor meetings](#)

[OTAs in the Quarter \(1Q26\): Winning the Phony War](#)

[OTAs: Updates from Airbnb's Summer Release, Google I/O, and Expedia EXPLORE 26](#)

[OTAs: Google didn't kill the OTAs, so why might AI?](#)

Recent research on Hotels:

[Quick Take: Marriott - WSJ letter suggests owners want more Credit Card Cash](#)

[Hyatt: Thesis recap & key highlights from the 2026 investor day](#)

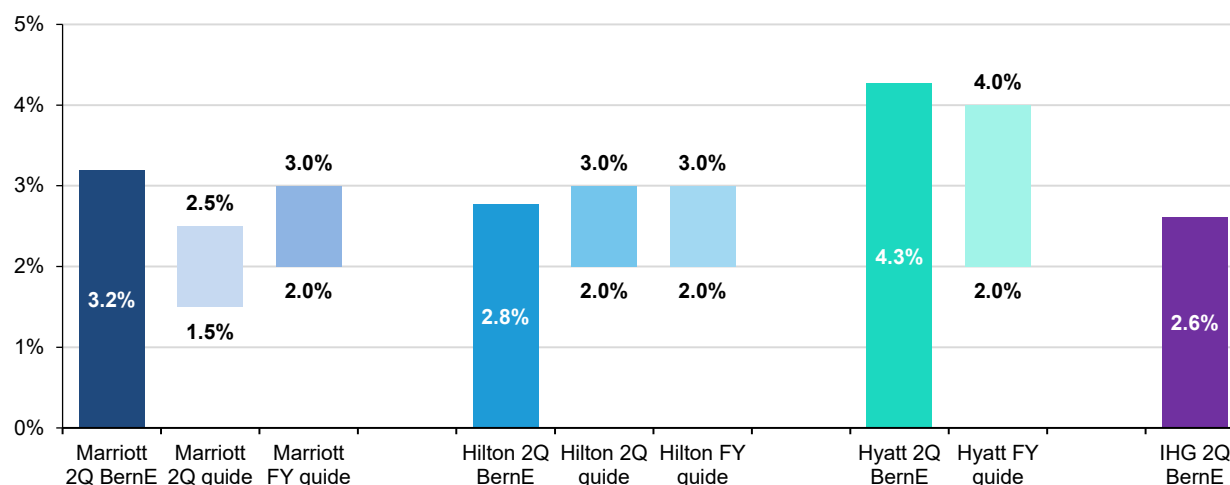
[Lodging in the Quarter \(1Q26\): K-Popped? Not yet - Hyatt back to top pick on H2 inflection](#)

[Global Hotels: Key takeaways from our expert franchisee calls](#)

[Global Hotels and Cruise: Artificial Intelligence.... Sooner or Later - do bots take vacations?](#)

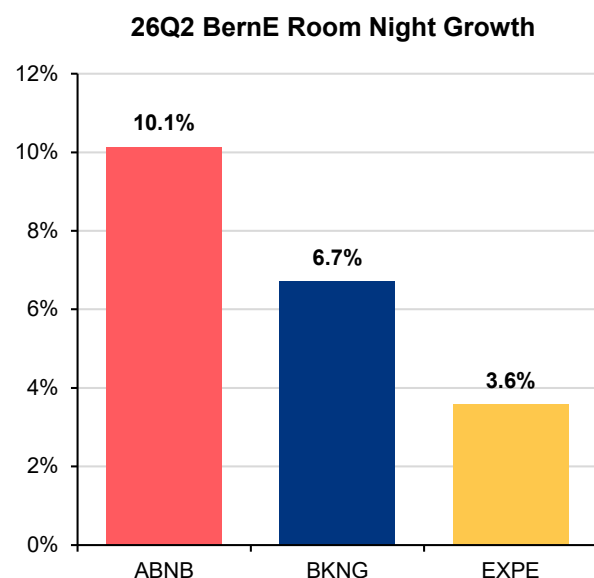
EXHIBIT 1: Under April - May performance and assuming early June performance will continue through the month, we expect Marriott to beat their Q2 RevPAR guidance, and Hilton to come right at the top end of their 2-3% range

Hotels: 26Q2 RevPAR growth estimate (Apr-May run rate + June assumption) vs guidance



Source: CoStar, Bernstein analysis & estimates

EXHIBIT 2: Airbnb is set to lead room night growth given the current traffic data



We have included no effect yet from elevated cancellations or a positive effect from RNPL at Airbnb

Source: SensorTower, SimilarWeb, Company reports, Bernstein analysis & estimates

EXHIBIT 3: Based on current traffic data, we expect Airbnb and Booking to outperform consensus on room nights, while Expedia is likely to underperform

2Q26	ABNB	BKNG	EXPE
(Room) Nights Booked			
BernE	148.0	329.7	109.3
Consensus	145.7	320.0	110.9
vs	1.6%	3.0%	-1.5%

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis & estimates

DETAILS

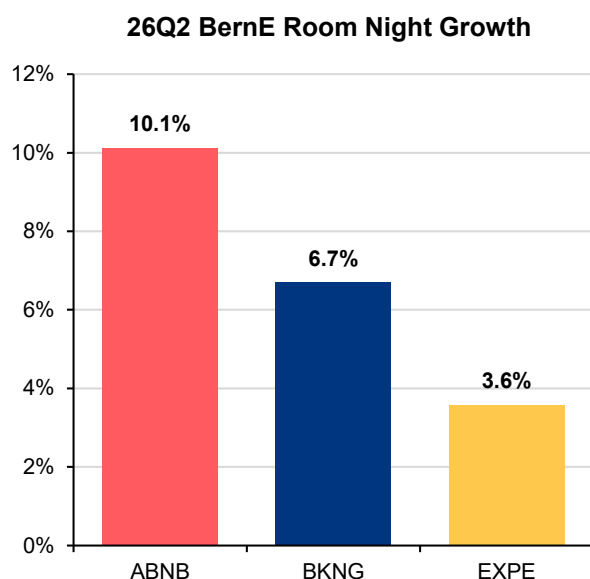
ONLINE TRAVEL AGENTS

EXHIBIT 4: **Based on current traffic data, we expect Airbnb and Booking to outperform consensus on room nights, while Expedia is likely to underperform**

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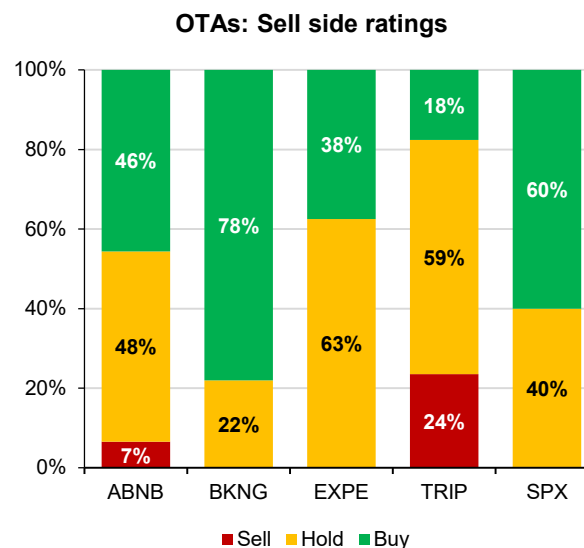
EXHIBIT 5: **Airbnb is set to lead room night growth given the current traffic data**



We have included no effect yet from elevated cancellations or a positive effect from RNPL at Airbnb

Source: SensorTower, SimilarWeb, Company reports, Bernstein analysis & estimates

EXHIBIT 6: **Only BKNG is preferred to the SPX by the sell side**



Ratings as at 19 June 2026

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

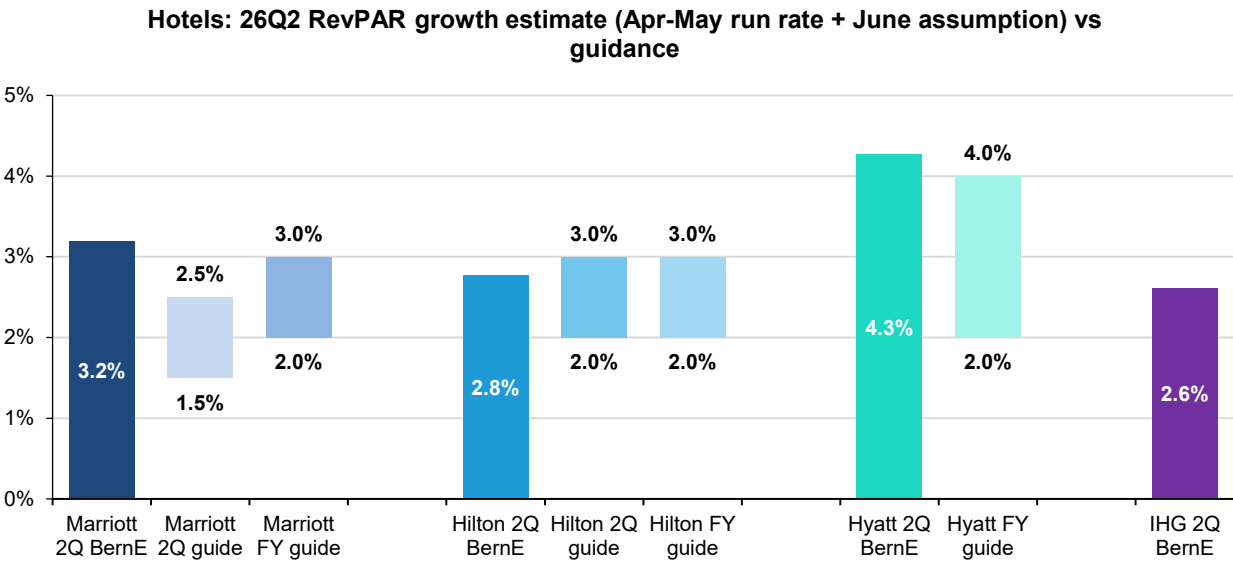
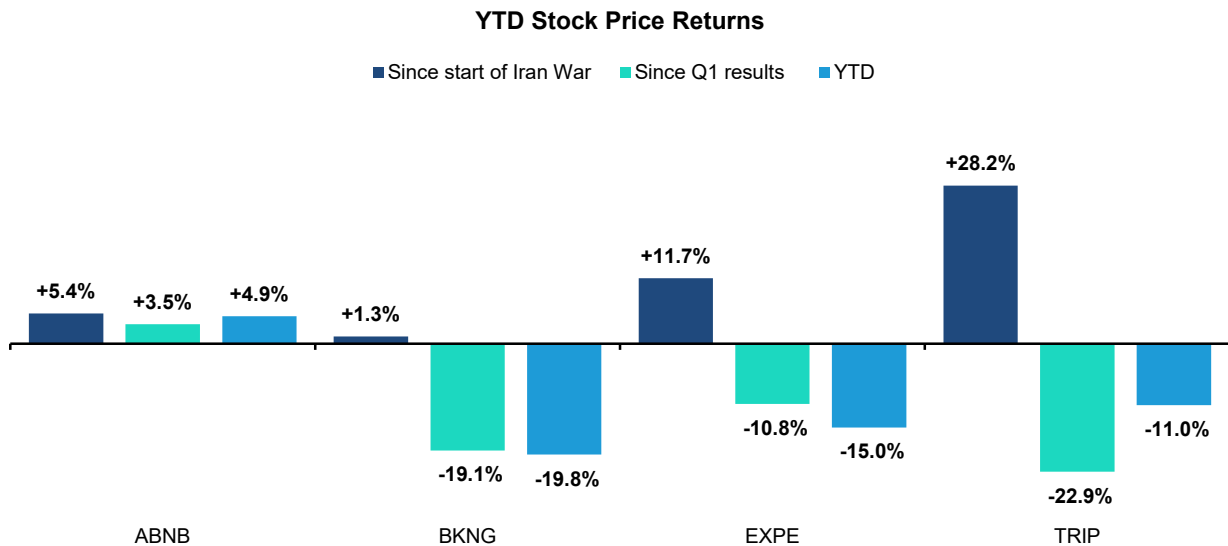


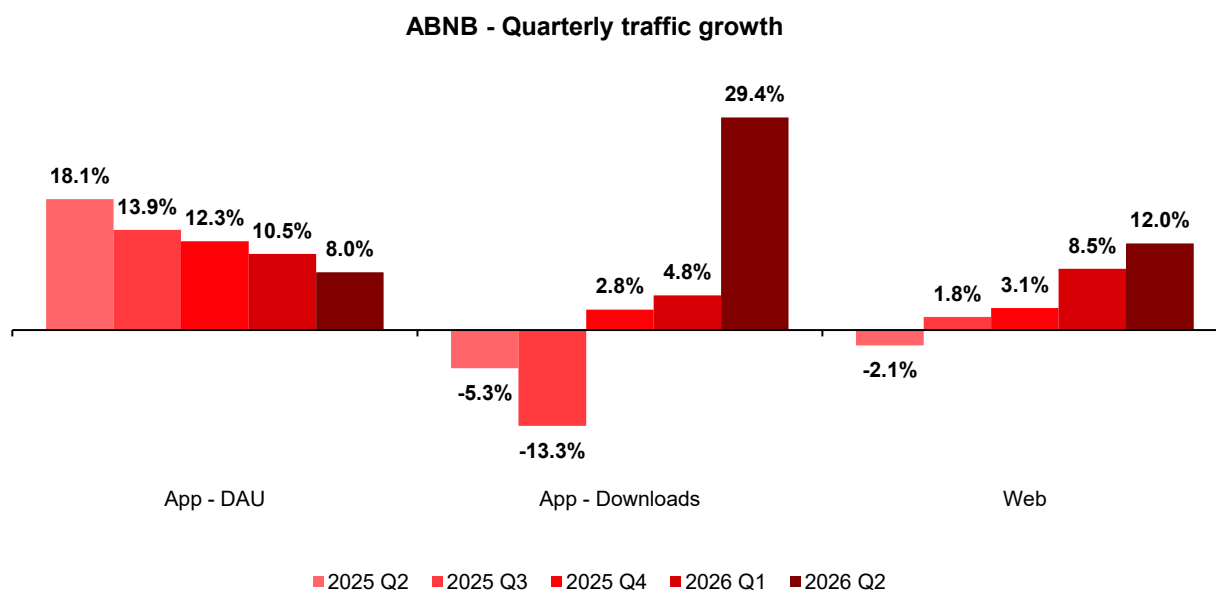
EXHIBIT 8: Only Airbnb recorded a gain in share price following the Q1 results



Share prices as of 19 June 2026
Source: CapIQ, Bernstein analysis & estimates

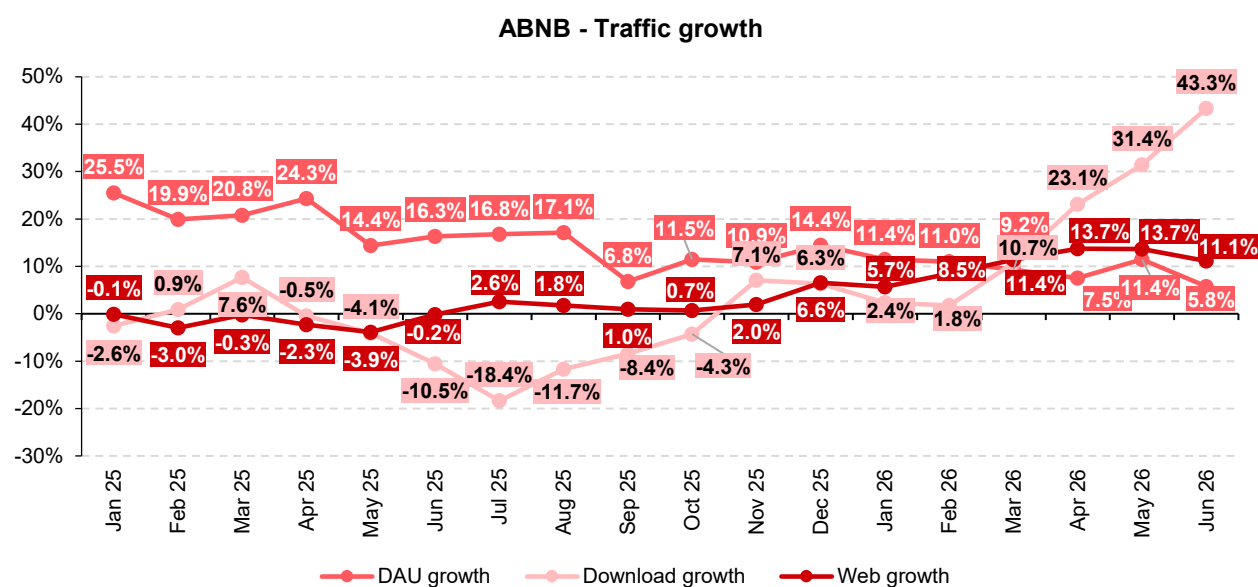
AIRBNB

EXHIBIT 9: Airbnb's web traffic continues to accelerate whilst app engagement growth has eased slightly; app downloads has accelerated significantly to ~30% y/y growth



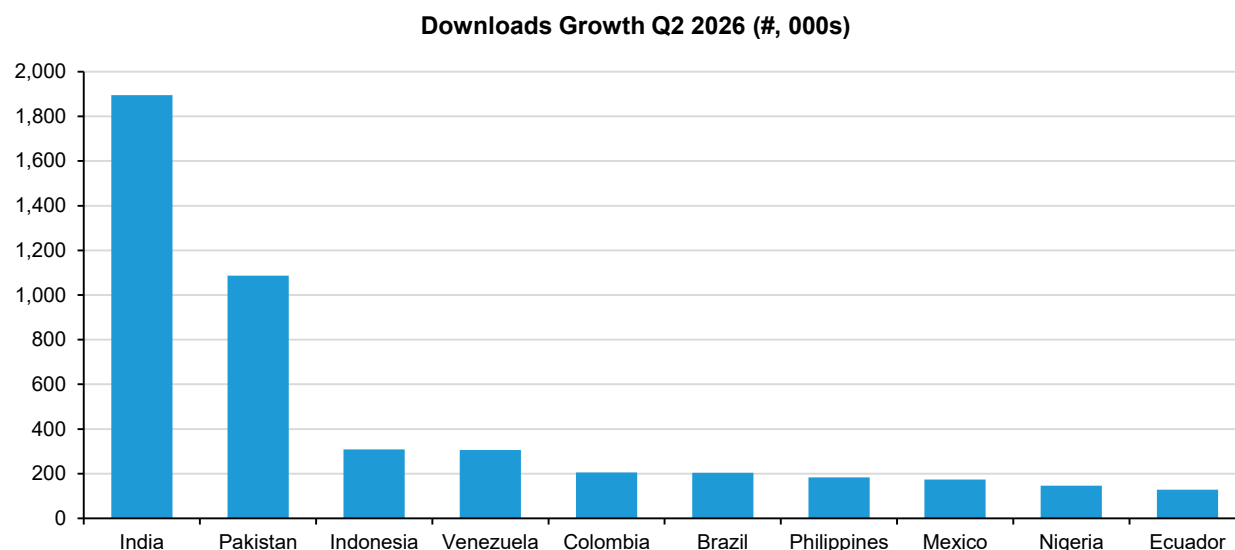
Source: SensorTower, SimilarWeb, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 10: Web traffic has grown in the LDDs through the quarter so far with a slight deceleration in app engagement; app downloads has surged with June currently tracking for 43% y/y growth



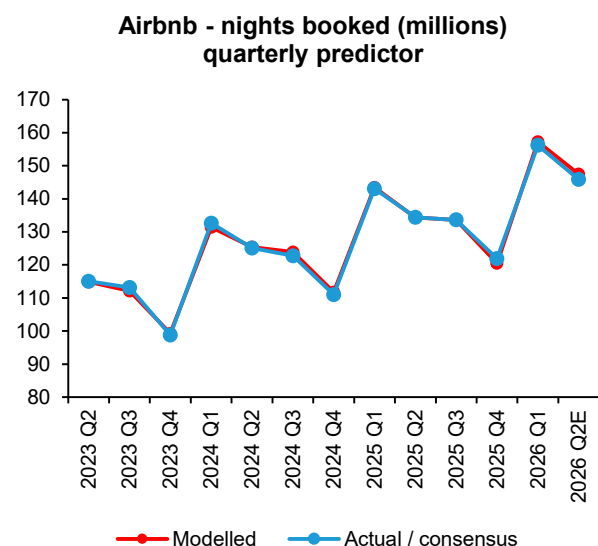
Source: SensorTower, SimilarWeb, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 11: India saw the largest increase in downloads versus Q2 last year, contributing to 34% of the total increase, following by Pakistan (20%) and Indonesia (6%). This is followed by three South American nations, with MSD % contributions.



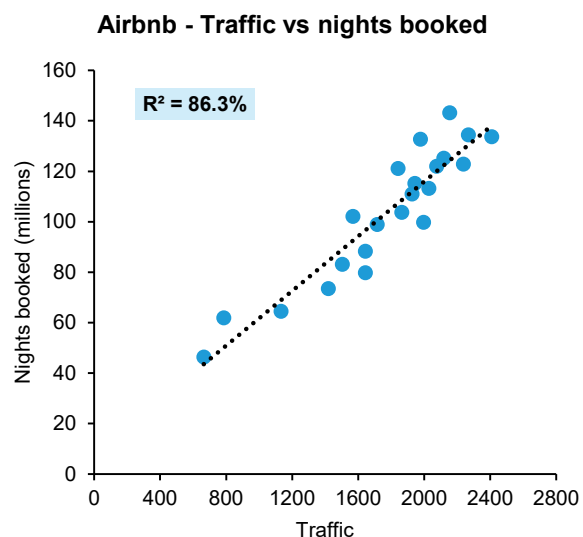
June downloads number adjusted for partial month
Source: SensorTower, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 12: Airbnb model vs actual



Source: SensorTower, SimilarWeb, Bernstein analysis

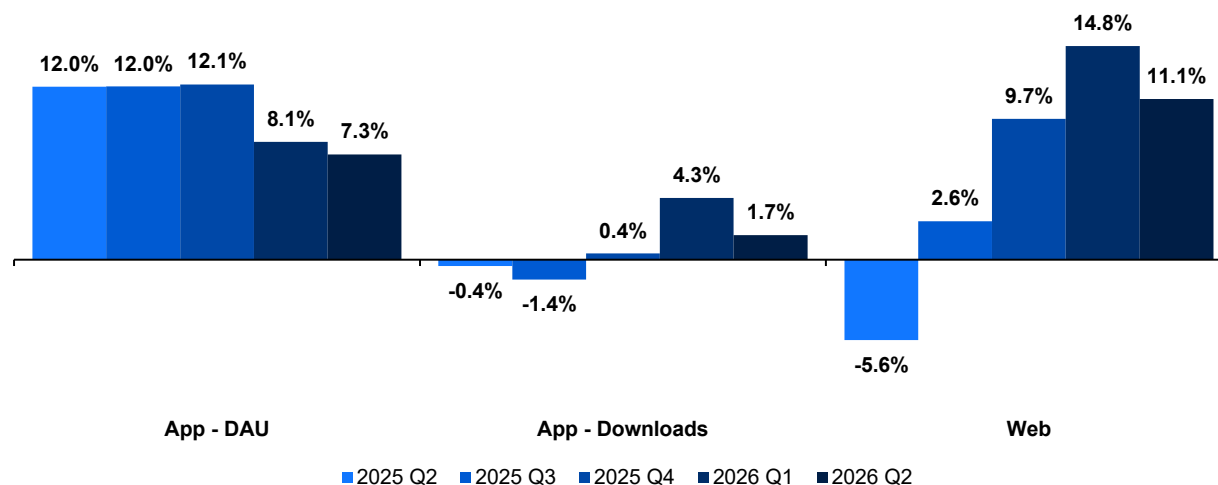
EXHIBIT 13: Traffic is correlated with nights booked



Source: SensorTower, SimilarWeb, Bernstein analysis

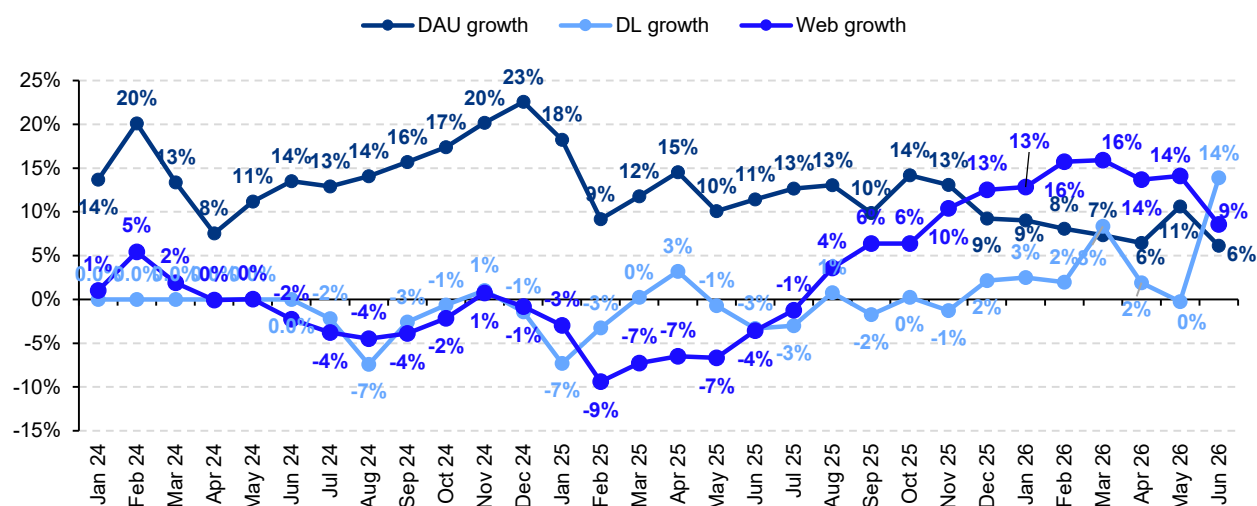
BOOKING

EXHIBIT 14: **Both app and web traffic growth have decelerated in the quarter driven by a weak start to June; app downloads is set to grow y/y in the quarter driven by a strong start to June**

BKNG - Quarterly traffic growth

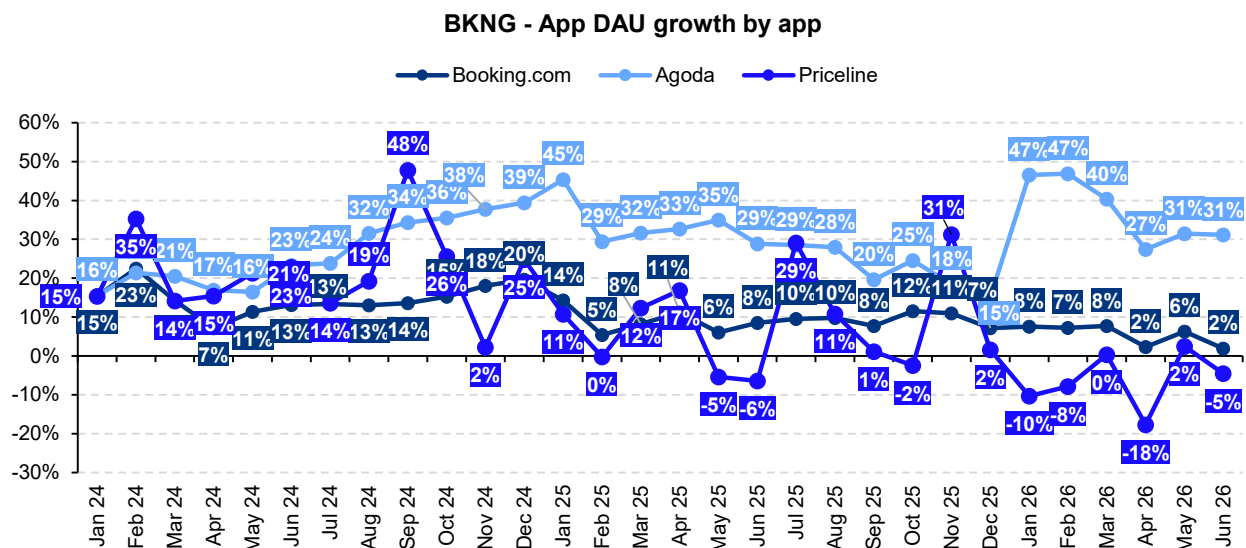
Source: SensorTower, SimilarWeb, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 15: **A weak start to June is the primary driver of weak app engagement and web traffic growth. Despite this, June has started with high app download activity, lapping a 3% y/y decline in 2025.**

BKNG - Traffic growth

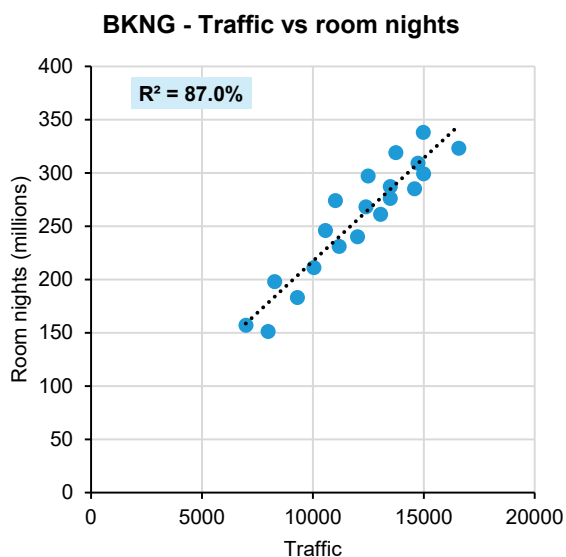
Source: SensorTower, SimilarWeb, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 16: **Growth at Agoda continues to exhibit strength but has slowed down from the 40%+ growth seen in Q1; the Booking app's engagement has decelerated whilst Priceline continues to struggle**



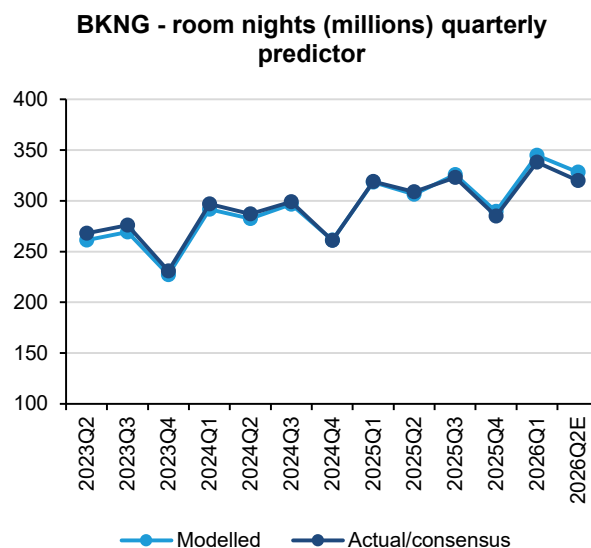
Source: SensorTower, SimilarWeb, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 17: **Booking's traffic is correlated to room nights**



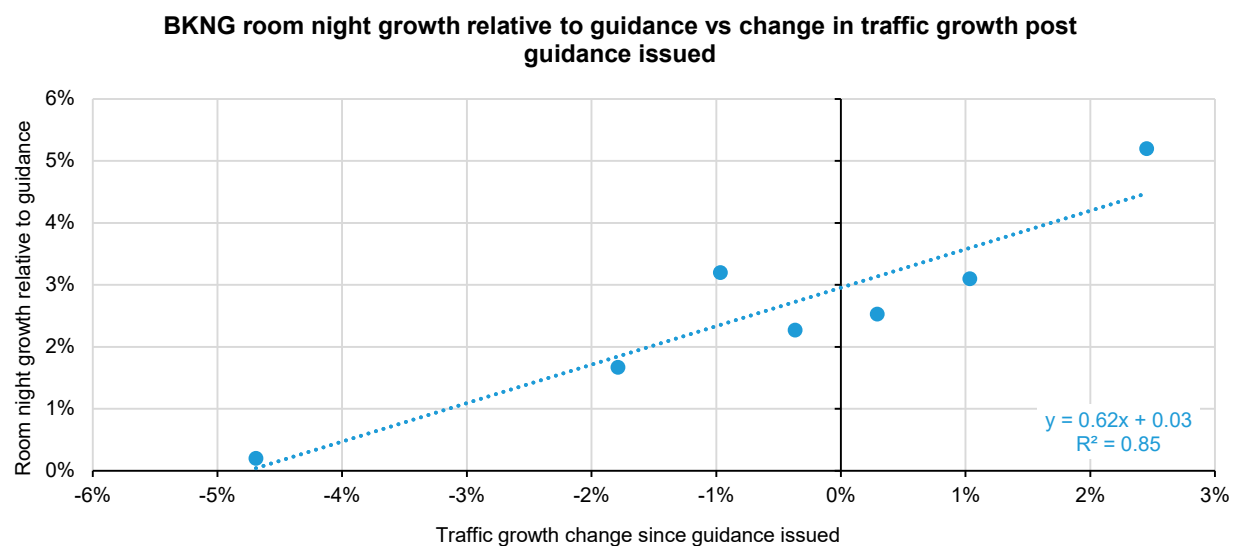
Source: Company reports, SensorTower, SimilarWeb, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 18: **BKNG model vs actual**



Source: Company reports, Bloomberg, SensorTower, SimilarWeb, Bernstein analysis & estimates

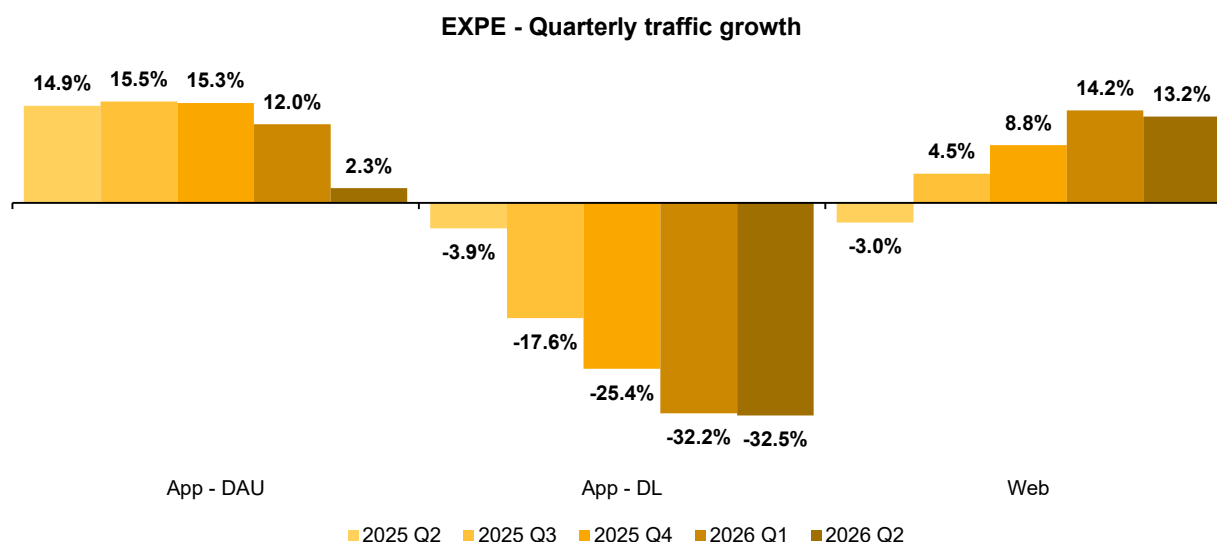
EXHIBIT 19: **Without any change to traffic trends post guiding BKNK usually beat their guidance range by ~2%, any change in traffic post guiding can impact how BKNK does on room night growth relative to guidance**



Source: Company reports, SensorTower, SimilarWeb, Bernstein analysis

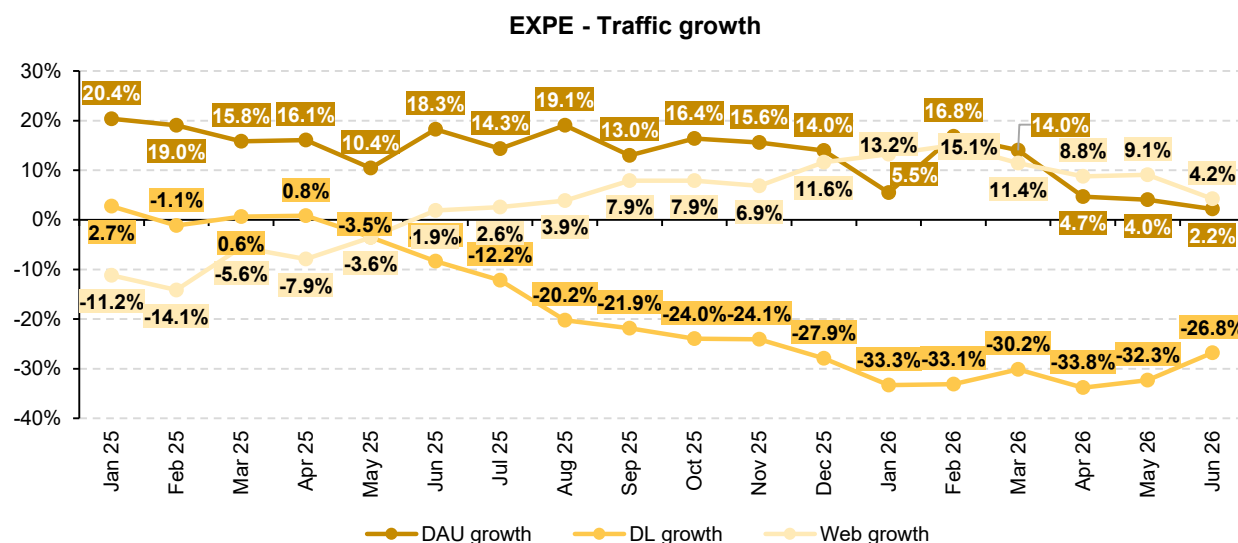
EXPEDIA

EXHIBIT 20: App engagement has been very weak through the quarter, set to grow just 2.3%, whilst web has also slowed following five consecutive quarters of acceleration; downloads growth now laps the beginning of declines in 2Q25



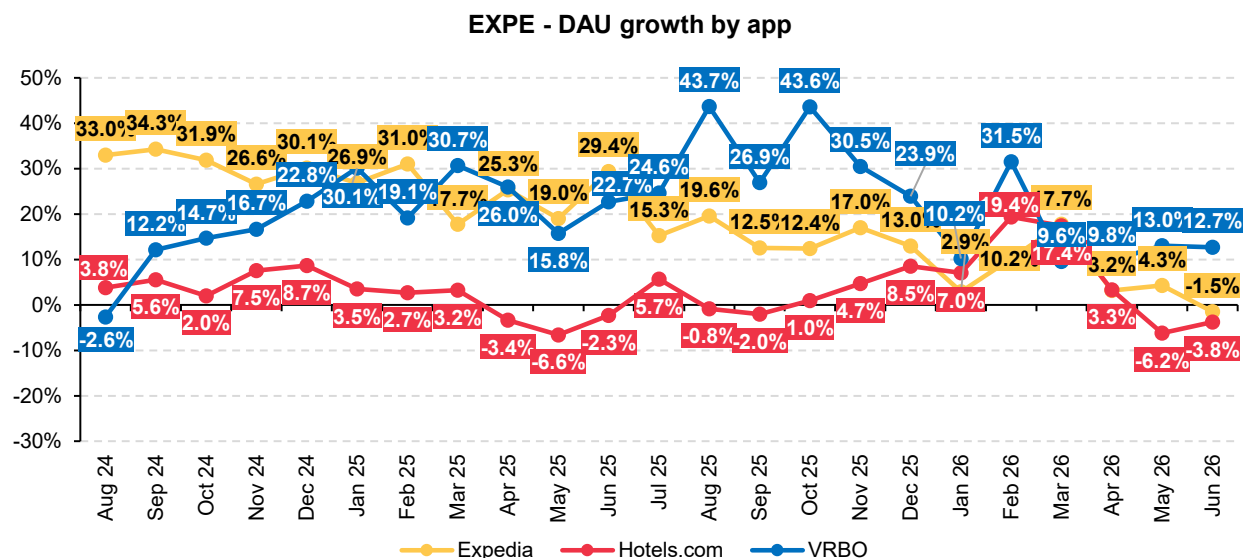
Source: SensorTower, SimilarWeb, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 21: App engagement and web traffic decelerated through the quarter; the y/y fall in downloads abated in June



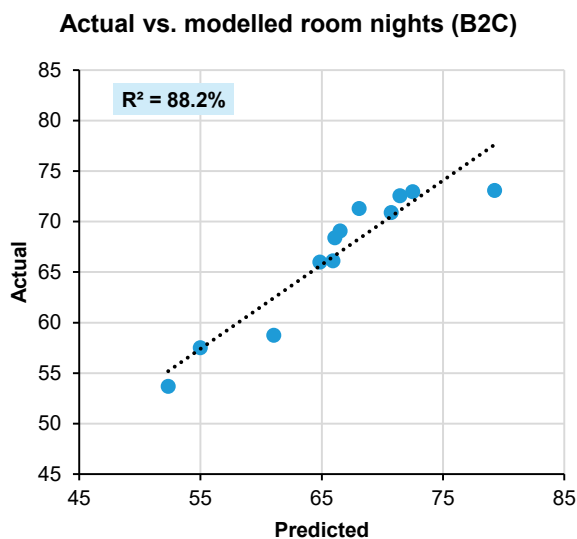
Source: SensorTower, SimilarWeb, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 22: **Both Hotels.com and Expedia have experienced a deceleration in app engagement through the quarter with y/y declines so far in June, whilst Vrbo continues to experience steady growth**



Source: Bernstein analysis, Sensortower, Similarweb

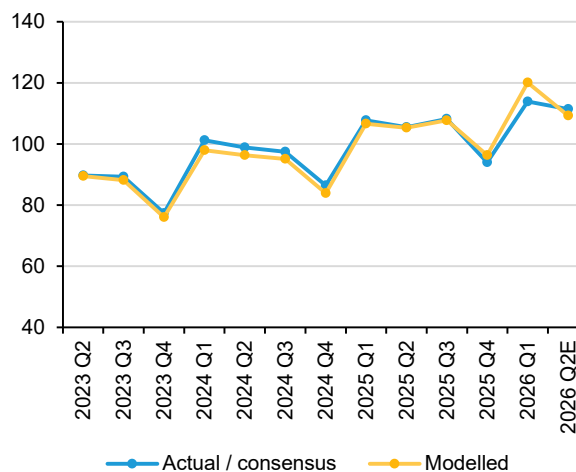
EXHIBIT 23: **Expedia B2C room nights are correlated with traffic**



Source: SensorTower, SimilarWeb, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 24: **EXPE model vs actual**

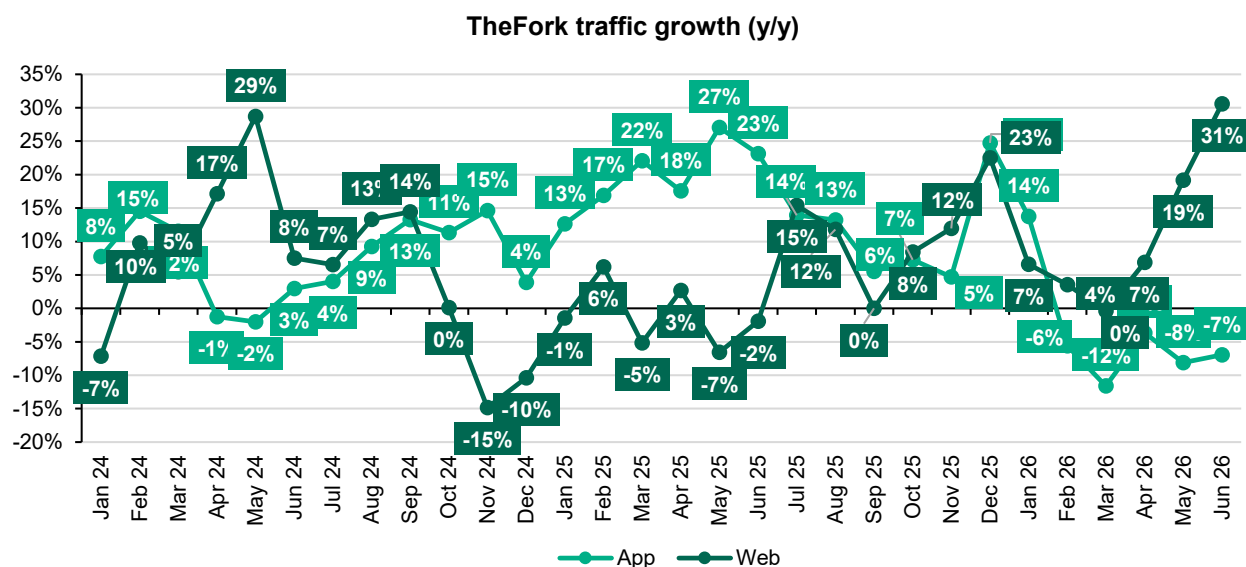
EXPE - Room nights (millions) quarterly predictor



Source: SensorTower, SimilarWeb, Bernstein analysis

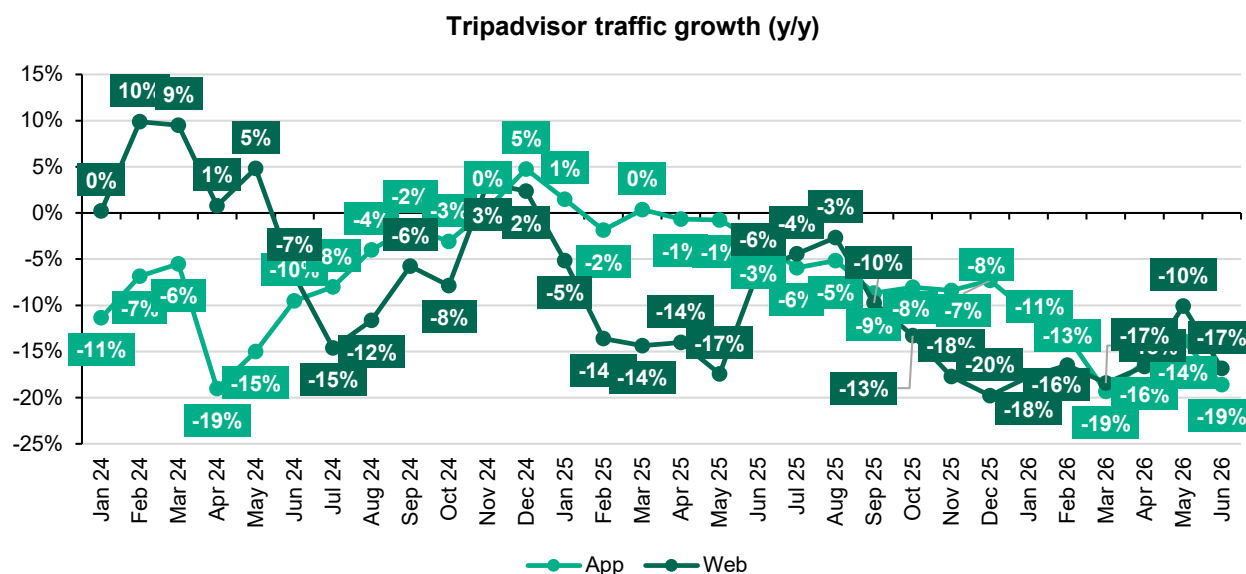
TRIPADVISOR

EXHIBIT 25: App engagement at TheFork continued its y/y declines into Q2, but web engagement growth has surged, running at 31% y/y growth so far in June



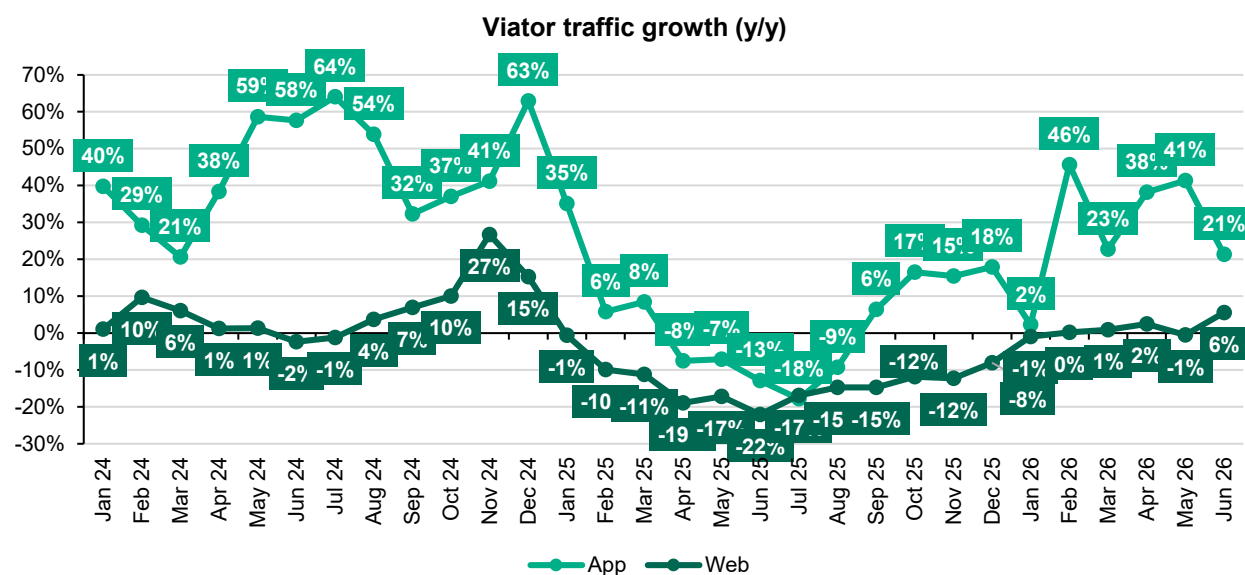
Source: SimilarWeb, SensorTower, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 26: Tripadvisor continues to struggle with declines in traffic across both web and app channels



Source: SimilarWeb, SensorTower, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 27: Viator, which suffered web traffic declines through 2025, has seen declines ease in last six months with y/y traffic up so far in June; app engagement at the Viator was strong in April and May with ~40% y/y growth



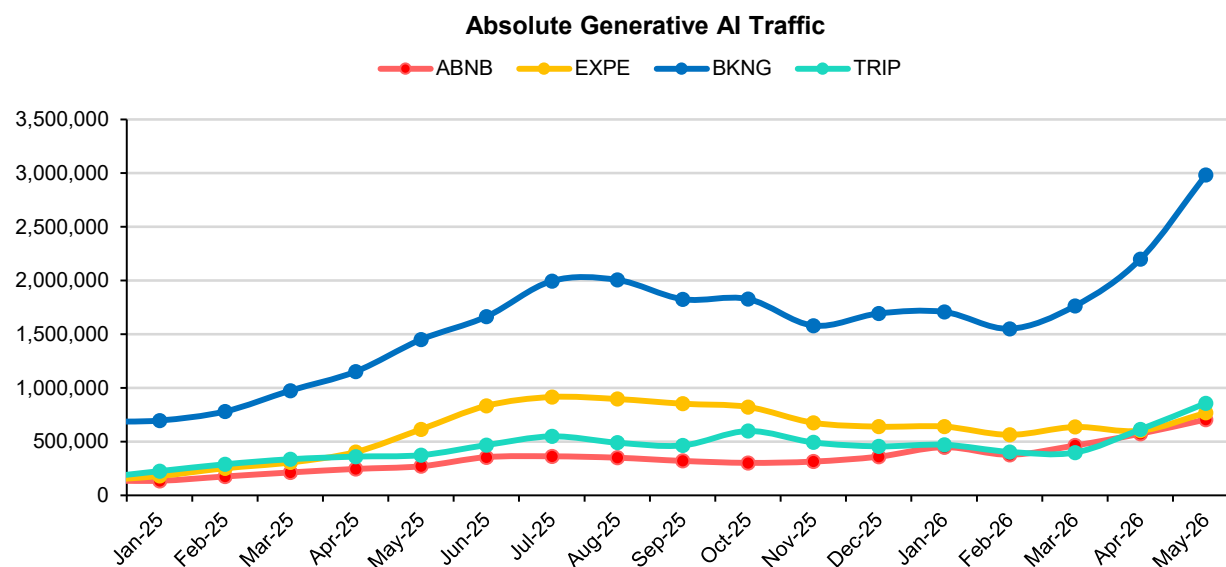
Source: SimilarWeb, SensorTower, Bernstein analysis

AI TRAFFIC

Referral traffic to the OTAs from AI seems to have inflected in April and May, with traffic growing 24% m/m in April and 31% in May, averaged across the four platforms. As a proportion of traffic, generative AI referrals have also inflected upwards, increasing by ~15 bps from March to May. However, these referrals continue to make up a very small proportion of overall traffic (<0.5%).

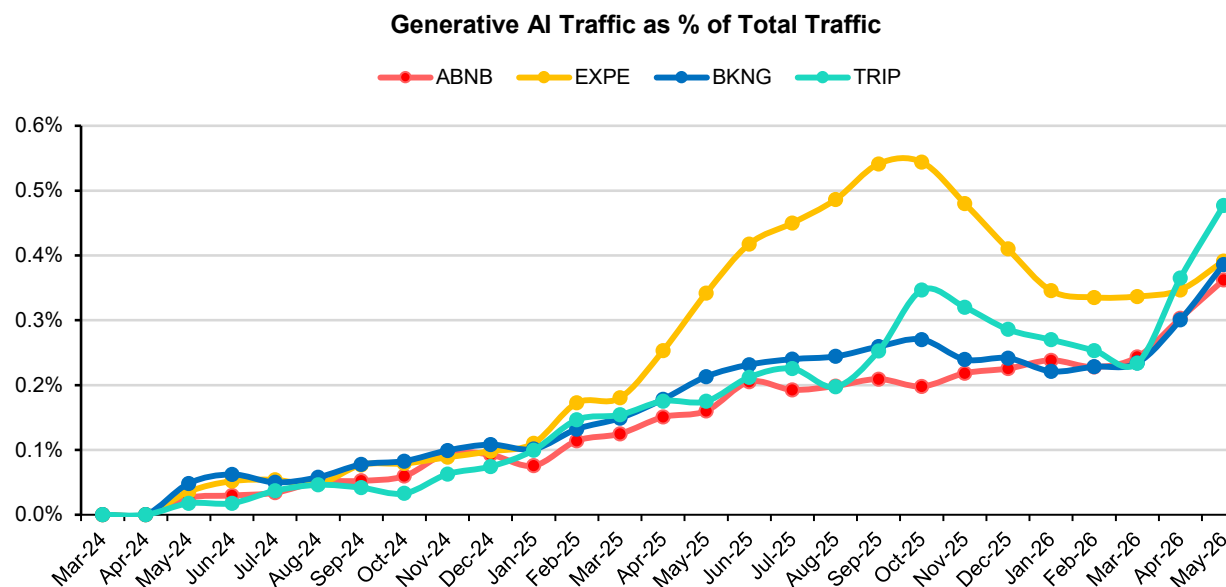
Automatic app suggestions could be driving this referral traffic. Now if a user tells Claude that it wants to book a hotel, Claude will automatically suggest using a Claude connector (equivalent to a ChatGPT app), bringing up a list of relevant hotel booking connectors (i.e. Booking.com, Trivago)

EXHIBIT 28: Traffic generated by AI sources to major OTAs, particularly Booking, saw a notable increase in April and May

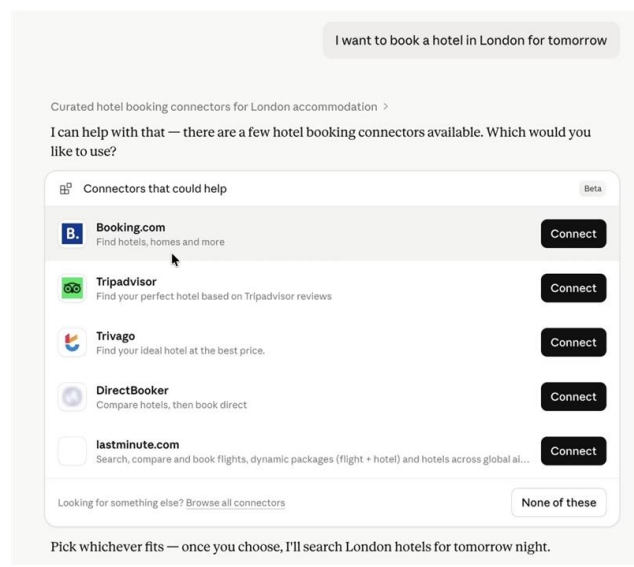


Source: SimilarWeb, Bernstein analysis

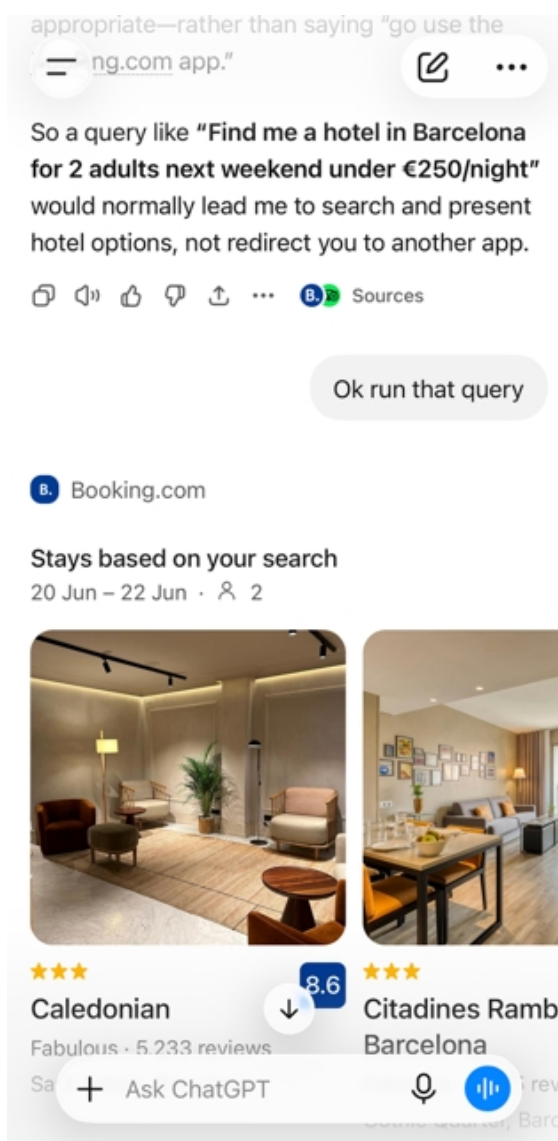
EXHIBIT 29: The share of traffic the OTAs derive from Generative AI has surged since March, but still sits at very low levels (<0.5%). This is potentially driven by increased leisure travel research ahead of the key summer travel period.



Source: SimilarWeb, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 30: Claude now automatically suggests relevant connectors (apps) to hotel search queries


Source: AgentDiscoverability.com, Claude, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 31: We can with a little trial and error, now get ChatGPT to call apps mid-flow rather than right at the top. Here is only calls one app - in this case Booking.com


Source: ChatGPT

HOTELS

REVPAR PERFORMANCE

The US. RevPAR performance accelerated through the first two months of Q2 at Luxury and Upper Upscale hotels, whilst a deceleration was experienced further down the chains scale. Despite this, there are some positive signs at the lower end of the chain scale, with the Midscale segment continuing to grow RevPAR y/y into Q2 and Economy growing RevPAR y/y for the first time since March 2025. With the World Cup underway, we expect June to be a bumper month for US hotel demand, with the toll end likely to benefit the most and compression to filter down to the lower end of the market.

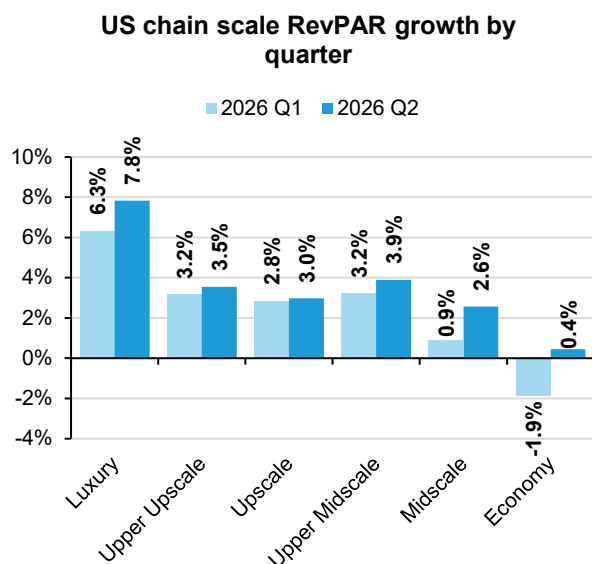
International markets. European RevPAR growth has taken a step down since February but continues to grow in the MSDs. Asia has continued its strength with APAC ex-China growing RevPAR at 9.7% y/y in May. However, the recovery in Chinese demand seems less certain, with RevPAR broadly flat in May. Despite the conflict in the Middle East, MEA managed to grow RevPAR in May, following a 25% y/y decline in April. This growth was enabled by strong religious travel demand in Saudi

Arabia which resulted in a 75% y/y increase in RevPAR. The Americas ex-US was able to grow RevPAR in May, following 6 consecutive months of y/y declines. With many of the World Cup spread across the US, Mexico and Canada, Americas ex-US should experience a tailwind from the tournament.

The latest weekly hotel performance. The most recent weekly data for the US shows a surge in y/y RevPAR growth in the first two weeks of June. This has likely a result of World Cup related hotel demand, with the first match played in the US on the 12th June and many travelers likely integrating wider leisure or even business travel before the tournament began. Luxury RevPAR was up 11.7% in the week commencing 7th June, with all chains scales bar Upper Upscale seeing an acceleration in y/y growth that week (Exhibit 38, Exhibit 39).

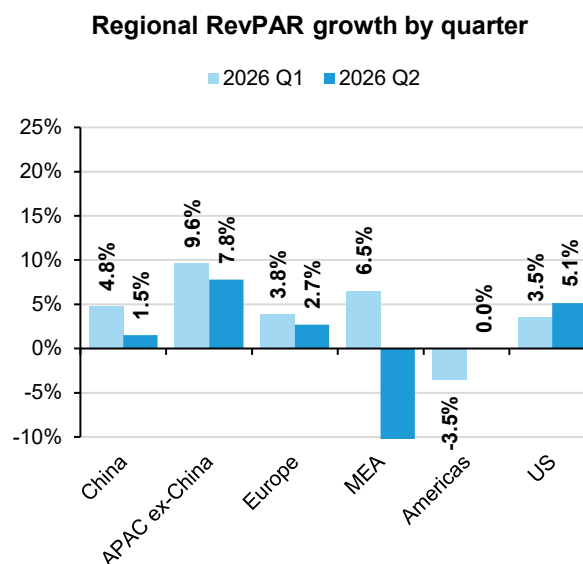
Company RevPAR forecast. Using RevPAR data for April and May, and assuming that the latest June trends will continue through the month, the companies are on track to grow RevPAR at around 3-4.5% in Q2. Given Hyatt and Marriott's exposure to World Cup host cities and over-indexing to the higher end of the chain scale, we expect them to benefit the most from the associated tailwinds in June. Under the current run rate and June assumptions, we expect both Marriott and Hyatt to beat the top end of their guidance range and Hilton to deliver at the top end (Exhibit 43).

EXHIBIT 32: Q2 RevPAR by U.S. chain scale: all segments saw growth.



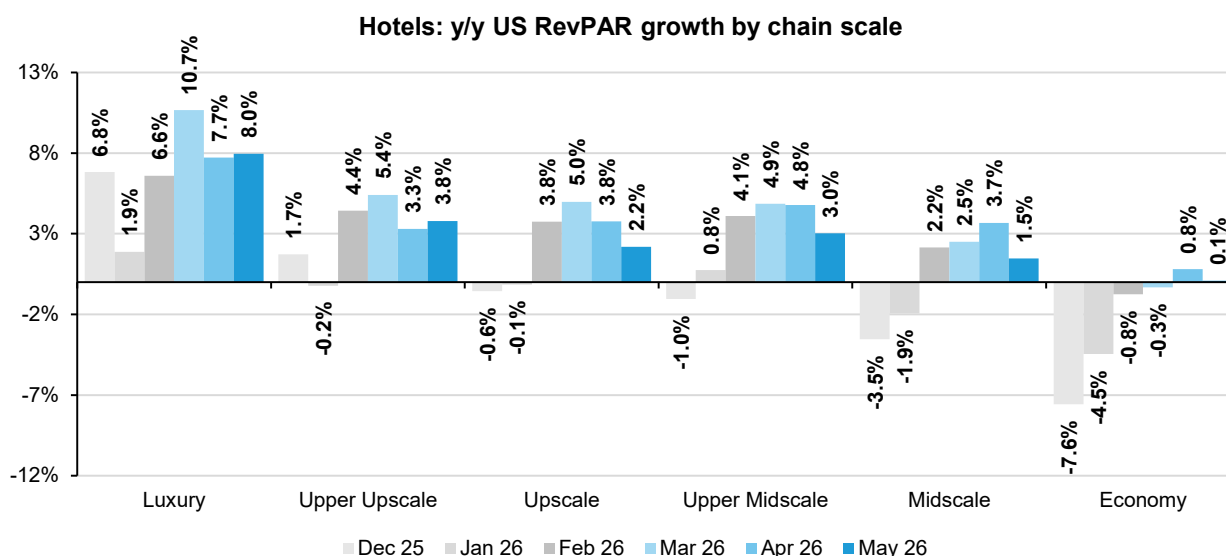
Source: CoStar, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 33: Q2 RevPAR by region: Americas and MEA saw declines



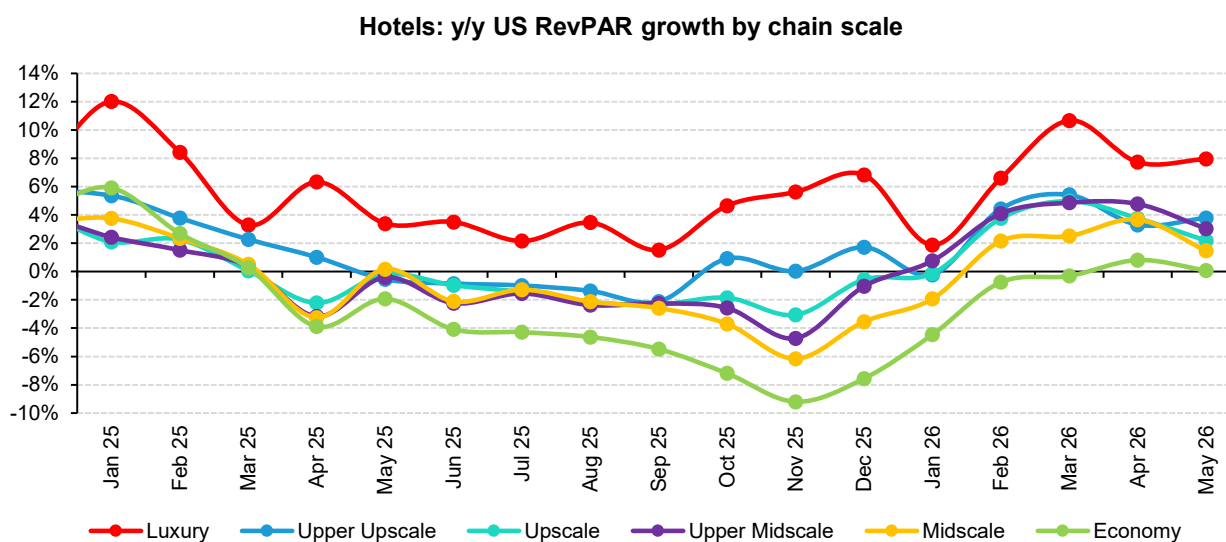
Source: CoStar, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 34: In the US, the top end of the chain scale continued to exhibit strength but the Economy - Upscale segments experienced a deceleration in May



Source: CoStar, Bernstein analysis

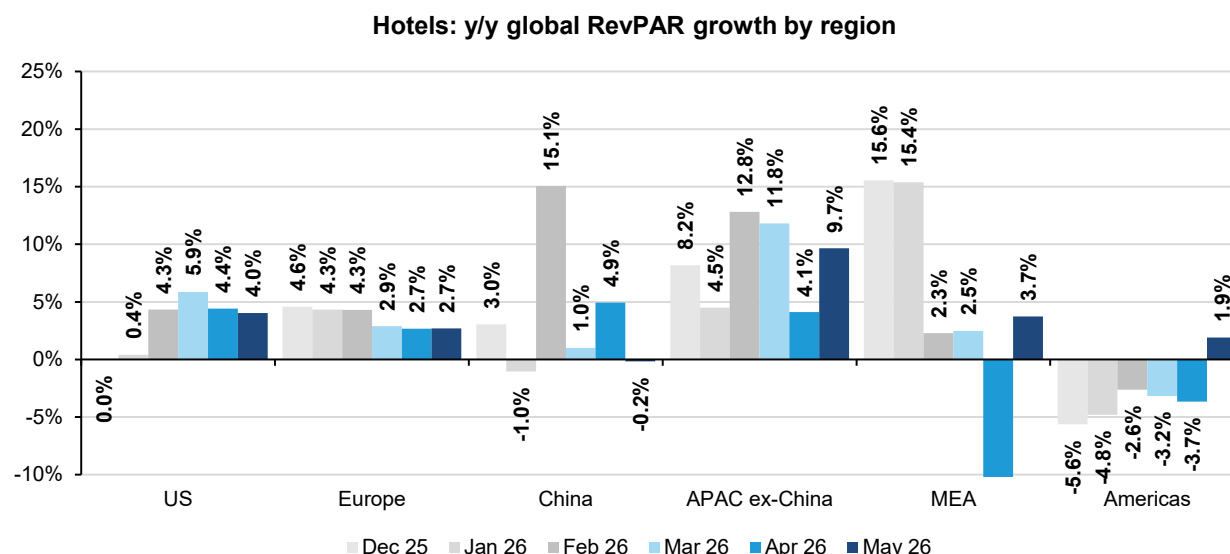
EXHIBIT 35: The Luxury chain scale continues to outperform the rest of the market, with a slowdown at the lower end, with Economy roughly flat in May and Midscale - Upscale decelerating to LSD growth



Midpoint of preliminary data used for Feb-2025

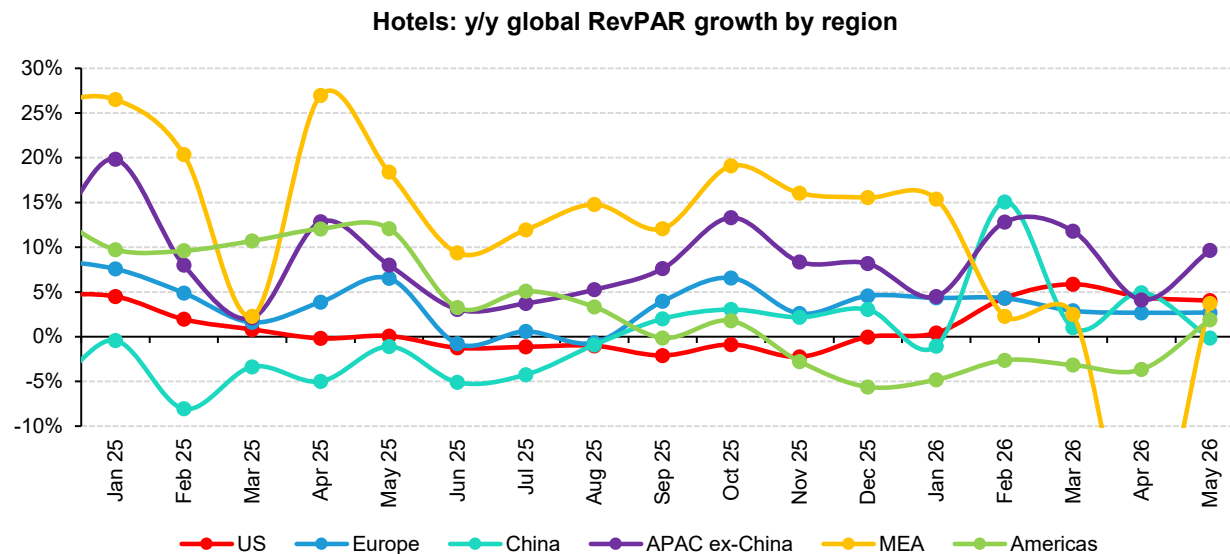
Source: STR, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 36: The US continued to grow RevPAR in the MSDs whilst European performance slowed; China failed to maintain its recovery with a y/y decline in May despite strength across APAC. The MEA region recovered to 3.7% in May, supported by strong religious travel in the KSA. The Americas returned to y/y growth for the first time since October 2025.



Source: STR, Bernstein analysis

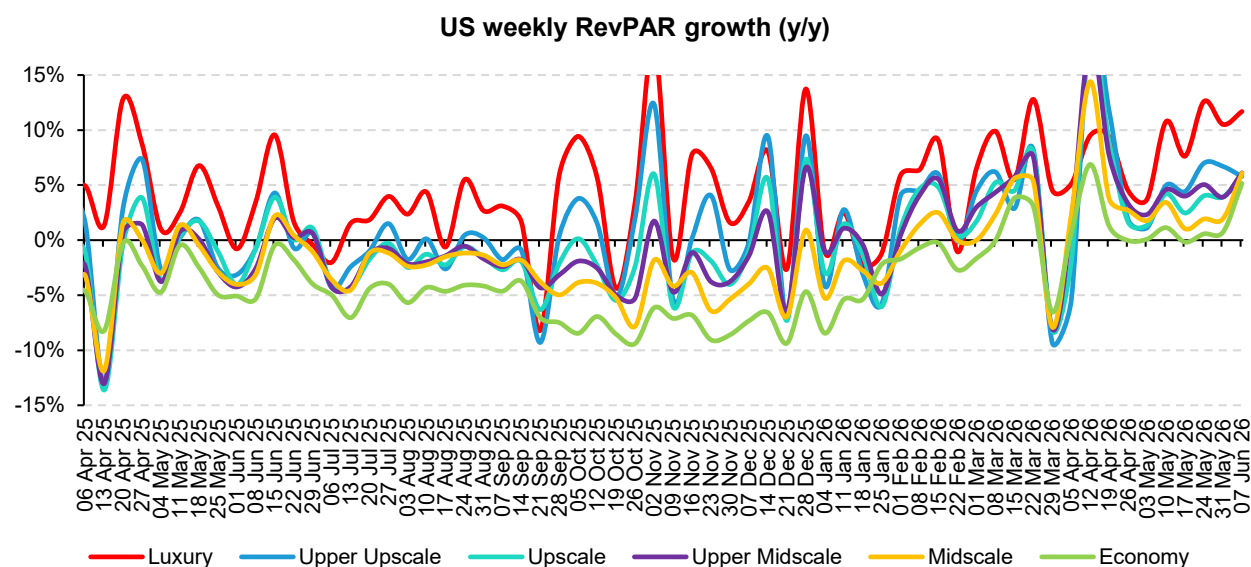
EXHIBIT 37: The Middle East has rebounded strongly in May after a 25% y/y RevPAR contraction in April, with recent strength driven by Saudi Arabia



Source: CoStar, Bernstein analysis

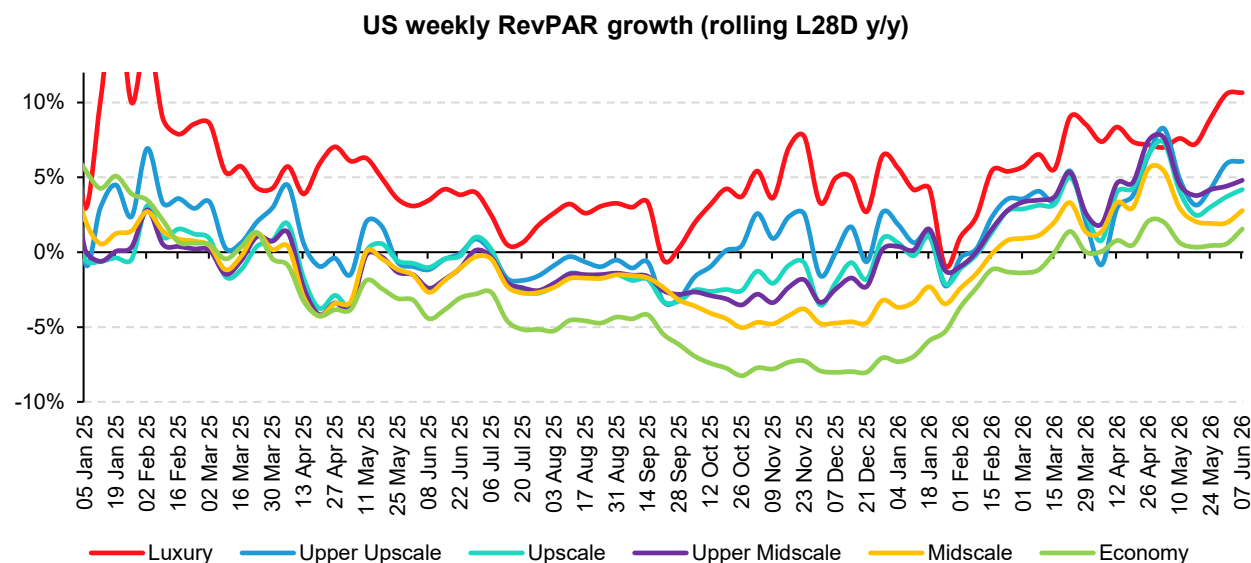
THE LATEST WEEKLY DATA

EXHIBIT 38: US RevPAR performance has surged in the first month of June, likely due to early demand from the North American World Cup



Source: STR, Bernstein analysis

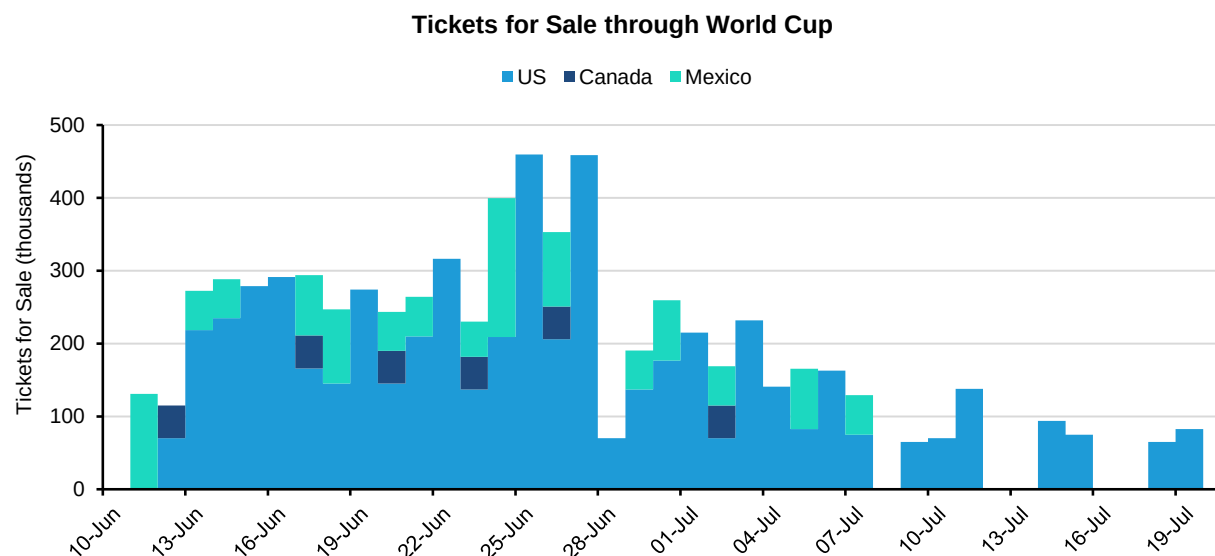
EXHIBIT 39: On a rolling basis, RevPAR has accelerated across the chain scale, with luxury continuing its strength in the LDDs



Source: STR, Bernstein analysis

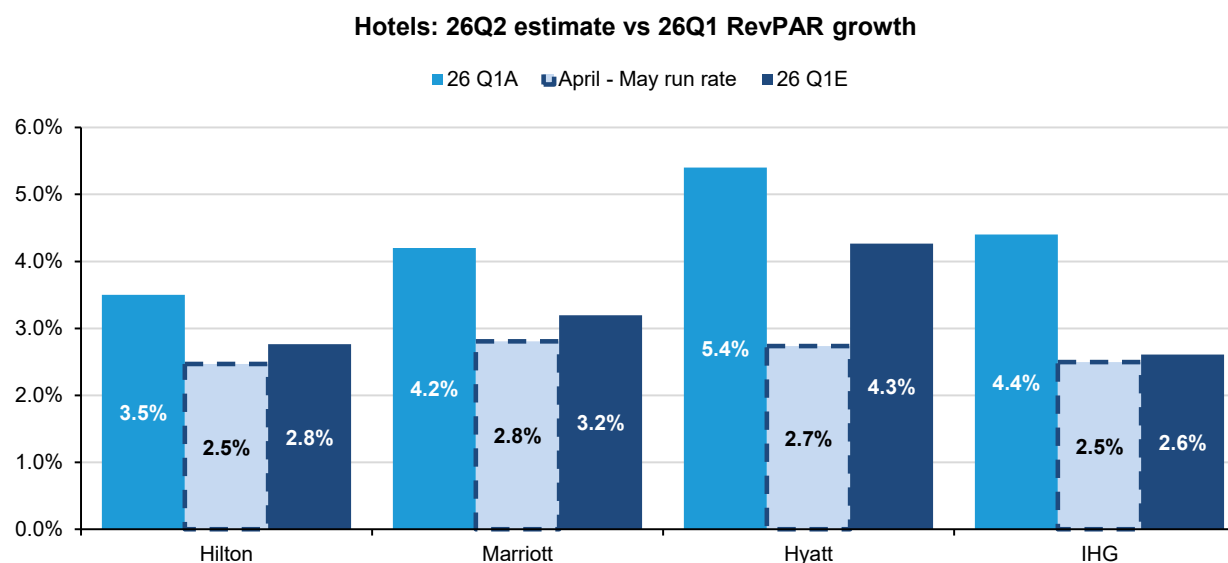
RUN RATE ESTIMATES

EXHIBIT 40: The number of tickets available for the World Cup peaks in late June but later games will likely elicit more interest and economic activity. The most important games are almost exclusively being held in the US.

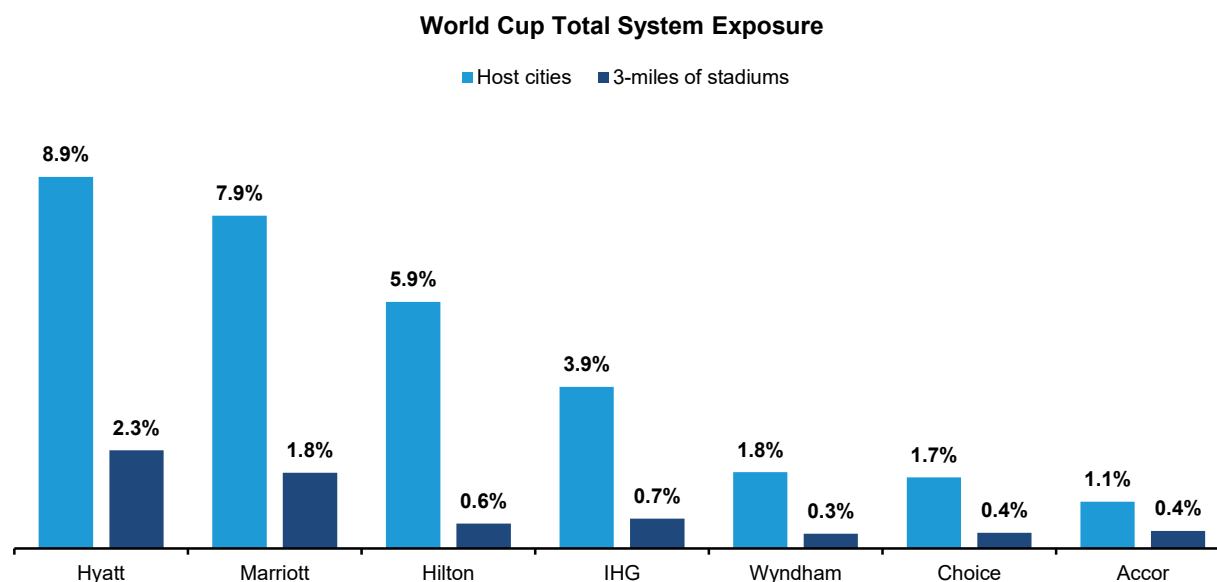


Source: FIFA, Bernstein analysis & estimates

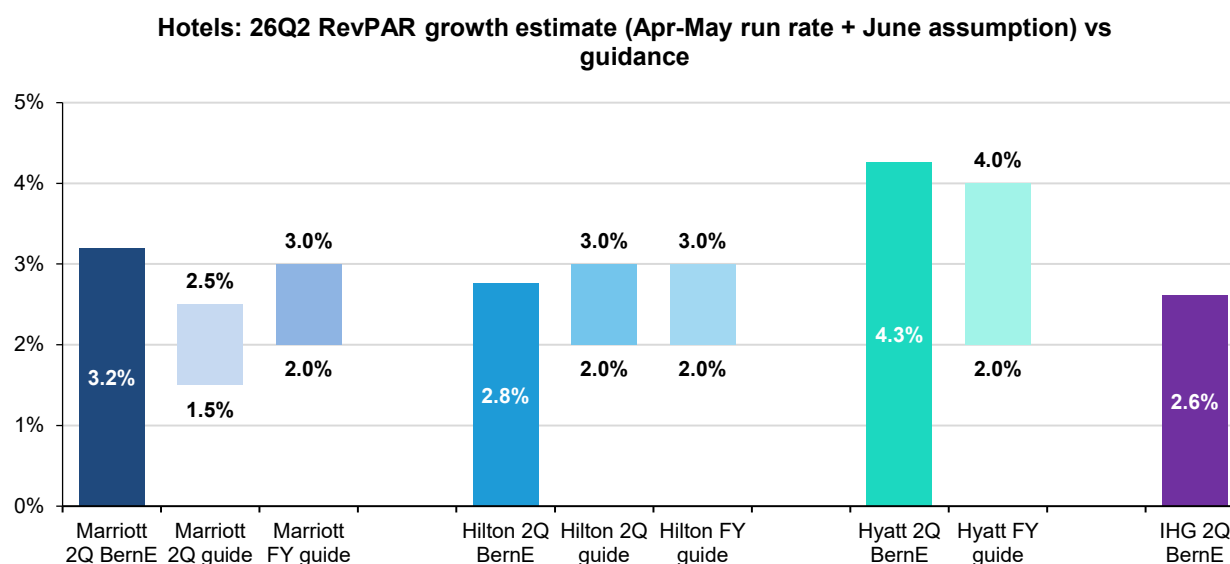
EXHIBIT 41: With June likely to be the biggest month for North American hotel demand in Q2, we assume June performance to track the latest weekly data, pushing our estimates above the April - May run rate



Source: CoStar, Company reports, Bernstein analysis & estimates

EXHIBIT 42: **Hyatt and Marriott lead in terms of exposure to host cities and near stadiums**

We use global room counts given in FY25 results
Source: Company reports, Costar, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 43: **Under April - May performance and assuming early June performance will continue through the month, we expect Hyatt to come in ahead of their FY guide and Marriott to beat their Q2 guide, and Hilton to come right at the top end of their 2-3% range**

Source: CoStar, Bernstein analysis & estimates

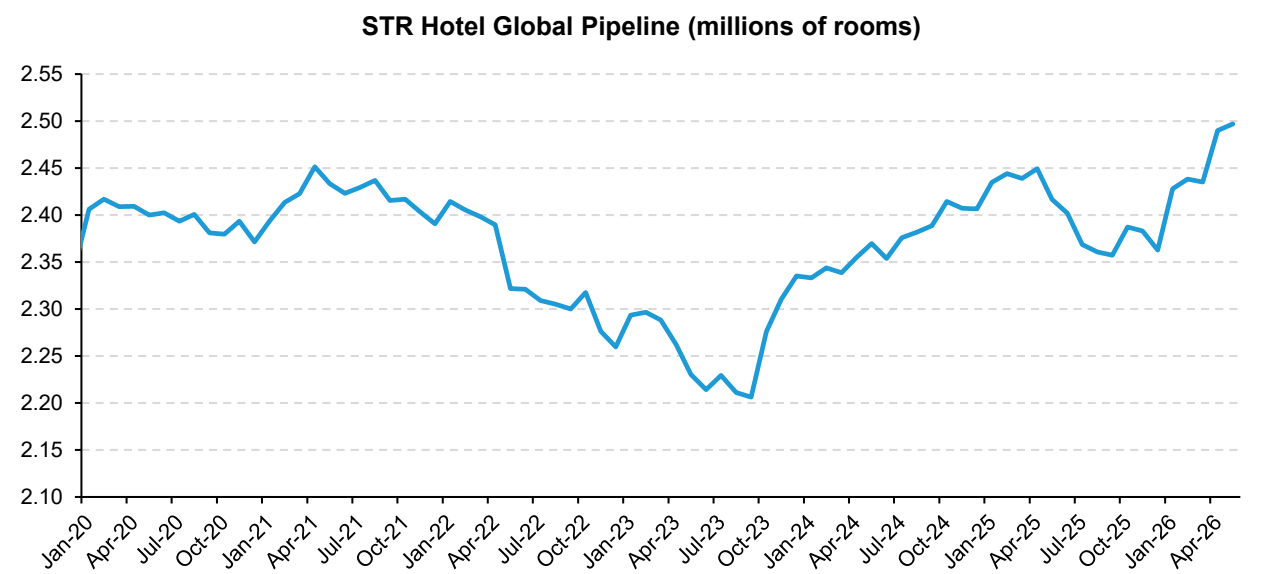
THE GLOBAL HOTEL PIPELINE SHOWS SIGNS OF RECOVERY

Following the global macroeconomic disruption from 'Liberation day' in April, we saw a sudden pullback in the global hotel pipeline - a rapid reversal of the post-pandemic recovery in 2024. This year we have seen a meaningful recovery, with the global pipeline adding ~134k room from December to May, and the current pipeline now ~48k rooms larger than pre-Liberation day levels. All regions have contributed to this recovery. APAC has been the largest contributor, having added ~61k YTD, with ~29k of these rooms added so-far this quarter. Rooms under construction also continued to increase, growing by ~16k rooms

through the first two months of the quarters (Exhibit 46).

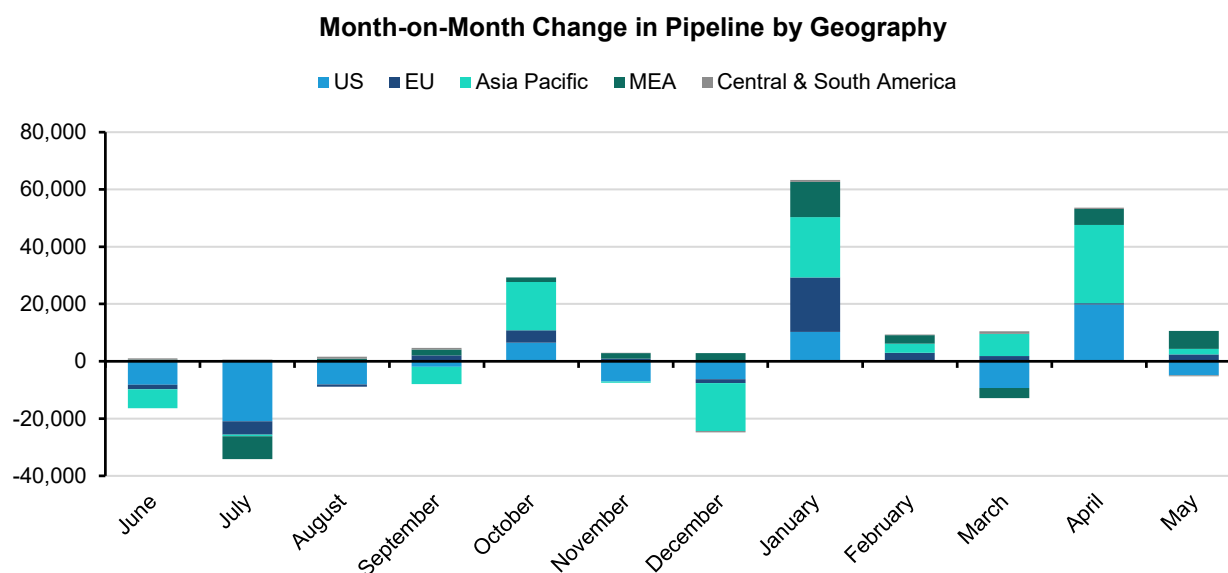
So far the conflict in the Middle East does not look to have had an impact on development, either in the MEA region itself or globally. MEA, which had consistently added to its pipeline since August 2025, saw some weakness in March, with the pipeline contracting by ~3.6k. However, this was more than offset by ~5.6k and 6.2k growth in pipeline in April and May. Rooms in construction is also strong, up 5.3% since February, but strong pipeline growth means the proportion of pipeline under construction has ticked down slightly. In other regions, the pipeline looks unaffected with all regions adding to their pipelines in April.

EXHIBIT 44: **The global pipeline added ~55k rooms in April and another ~7k in May, to more than offset the small contraction in March**



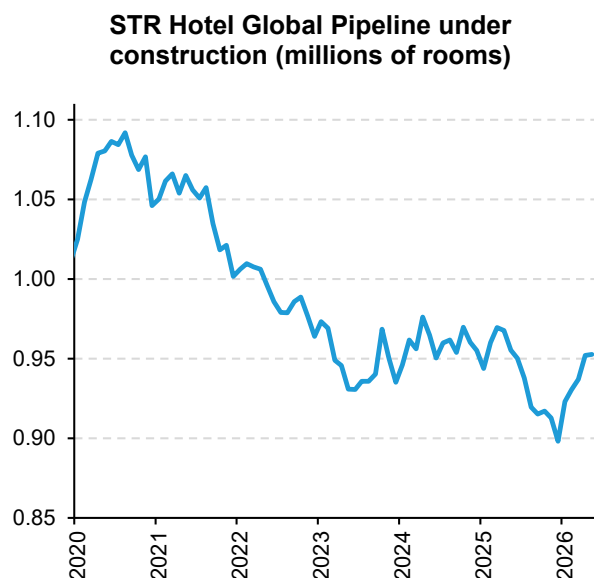
Source: STR, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 45: The US and Asia Pacific together added ~47k rooms to the global pipeline in April; MEA grew its pipeline in both April and May



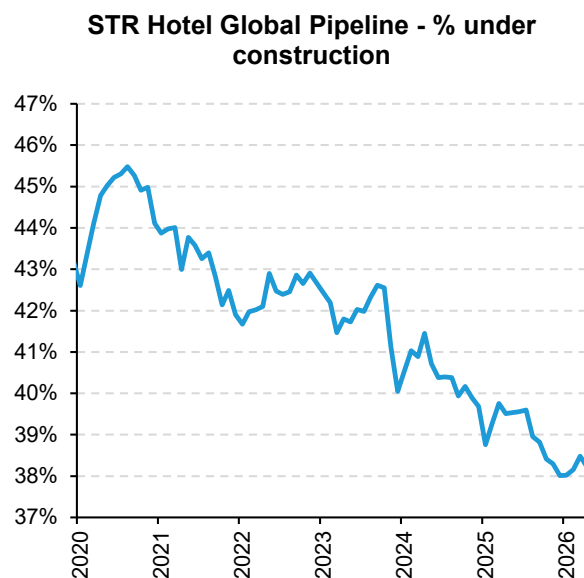
Source: STR, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 46: Rooms under construction has increased through the quarter by ~15.6k

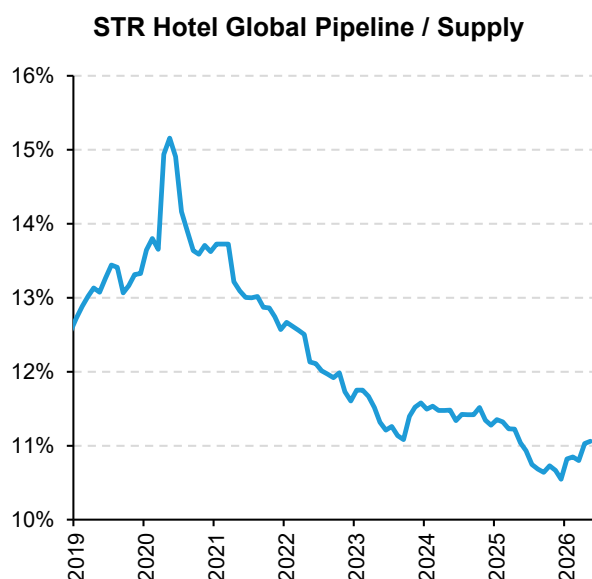


Source: STR, Bernstein analysis

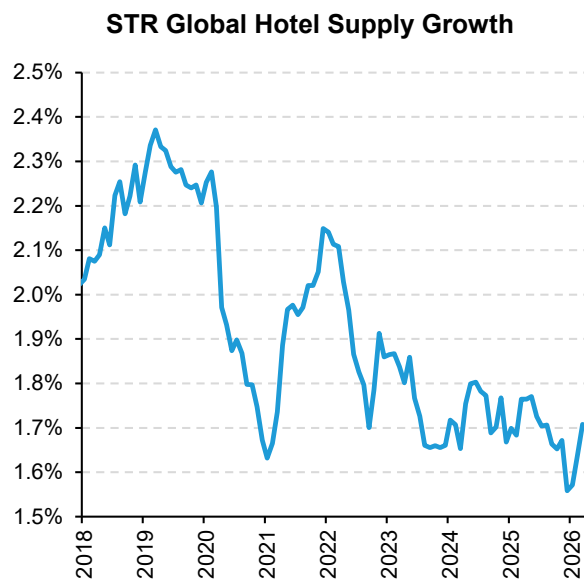
EXHIBIT 47: The % of global pipeline under construction ticked down marginally



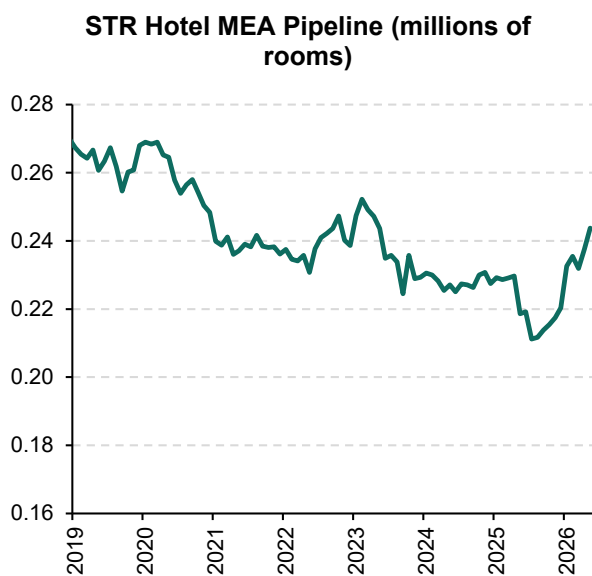
Source: STR, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 48: The relative size of the hotel pipeline continued to tick up

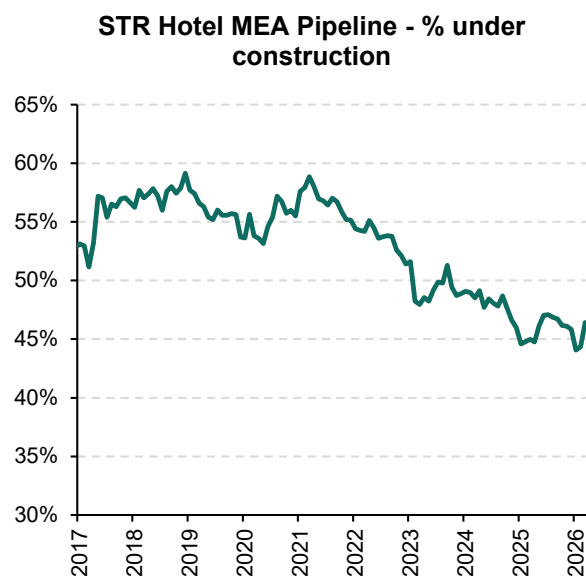
Source: STR, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 49: STR declared NUG ~1.7%, well off the >2% growth they used to set out

Source: STR, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 50: The MEA pipeline continues to grow despite the ongoing conflict in the Middle East, with the pipeline growing by ~12k rooms so far this quarter

Source: STR, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 51: Pipeline growth has offset a 5.3% increase in rooms under construction since February, resulting in a small tick down in the % of rooms under construction

Source: STR, Bernstein analysis

How are the brands doing?

The branded share of the global hotel pipeline continues to slowly decline approaching 78%, continuing a trend which began in the second half of 2024 (Exhibit 52). The big asset light groups share, around 50% of global pipeline, remains relatively constant, recovering so far this quarter from a decline at the end of 2025 (Exhibit 53).

Marriott - Marriott continues to have the largest share of the global pipeline of ~19% (Exhibit 54).

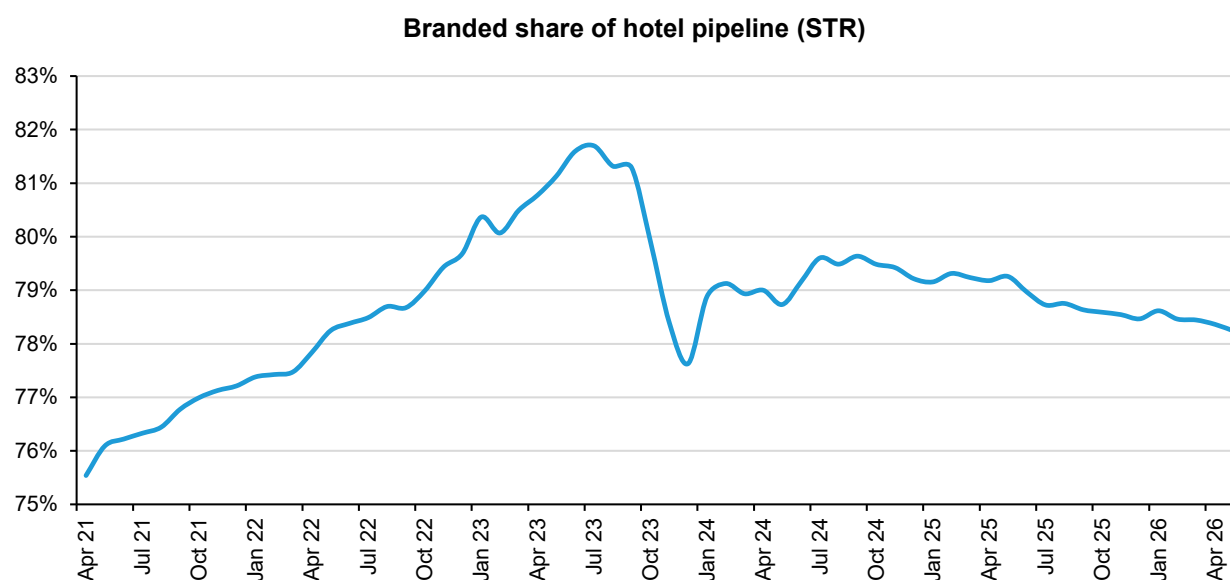
Hilton - Hilton's share of the global pipeline suddenly increased in April, as the company added ~26k rooms to its global pipeline (Exhibit 55).

IHG - IHG's share of the global pipeline is stable at around 10.5-11% (Exhibit 56).

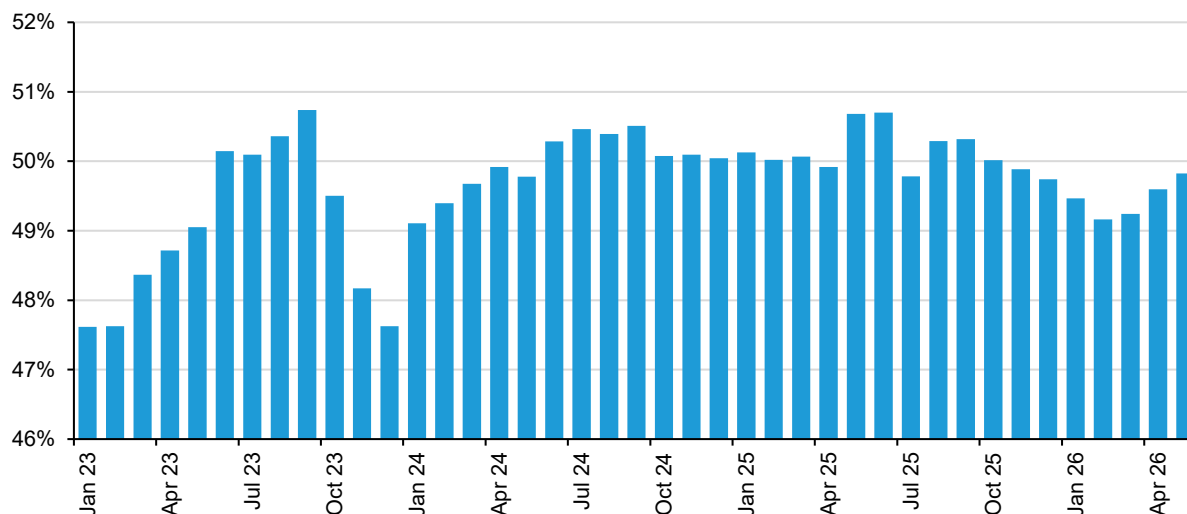
Hyatt - Hyatt's share of global pipeline has slowly increased YTD, having taken a step up in January (Exhibit 57).

Overall, brands are taking share in all geographies, making up a larger proportion of pipeline than they do existing supply. Furthermore, branded hotels dominate recent openings with over 90% of recent openings in the US and over 85% of new openings in APAC being branded. Further share gains will be most pronounced in LATAM and MEA where brands are responsible for nearly 90% of pipeline rooms. Gains will be less apparent in the US where the branded proportion of pipeline is roughly equal to branded share of supply (Exhibit 58).

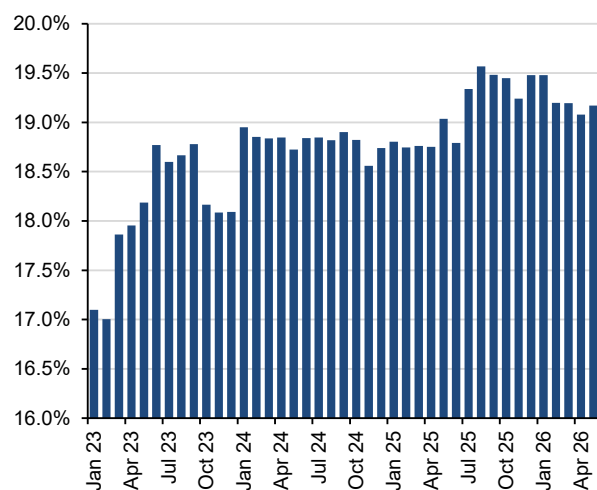
EXHIBIT 52: The branded share of global pipeline has steadily declined since the second half of 2024, now approaching 78%



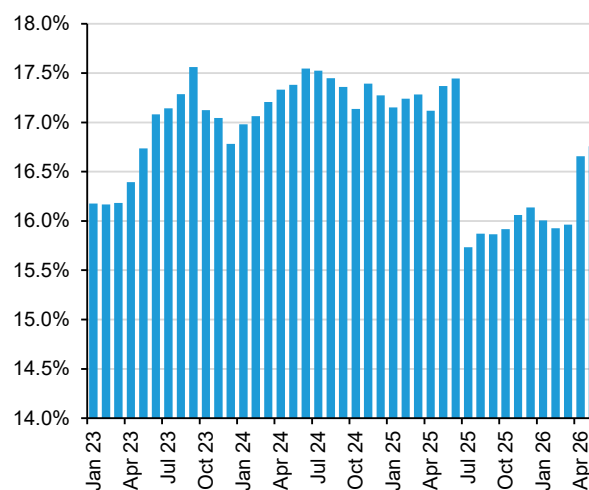
Source: STR, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 53: **The big asset light groups have helped drive pipeline strength YTD****Hilton, Marriott, Hyatt, and IHG share of global pipeline (STR)**

Source: STR, Bernstein analysis

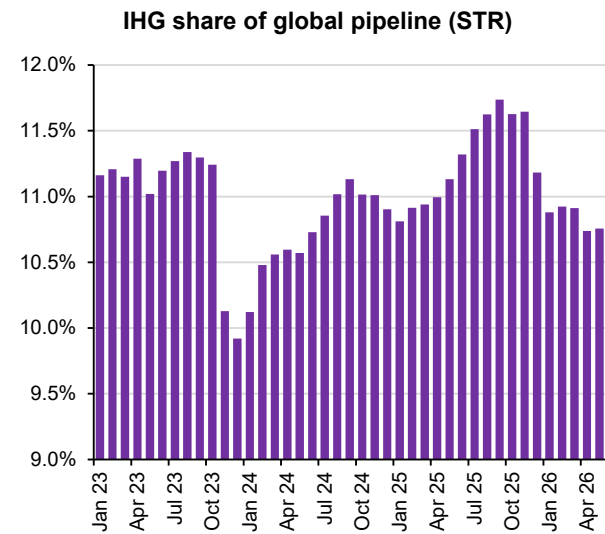
EXHIBIT 54: **Marriott has the biggest share of global pipeline at around 19-19.5%****Marriott share of global pipeline (STR)**

Source: STR, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 55: **Hilton added ~26k rooms to its pipeline in April, increasing its share of pipeline****Hilton share of global pipeline (STR)**

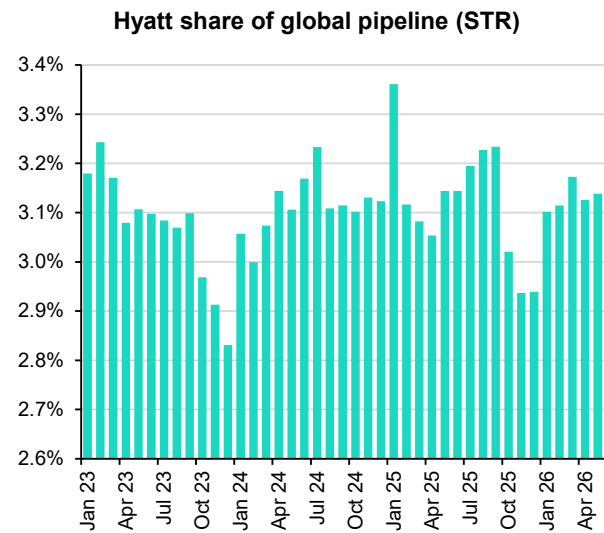
Source: STR, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 56: IHG share of pipeline is steady



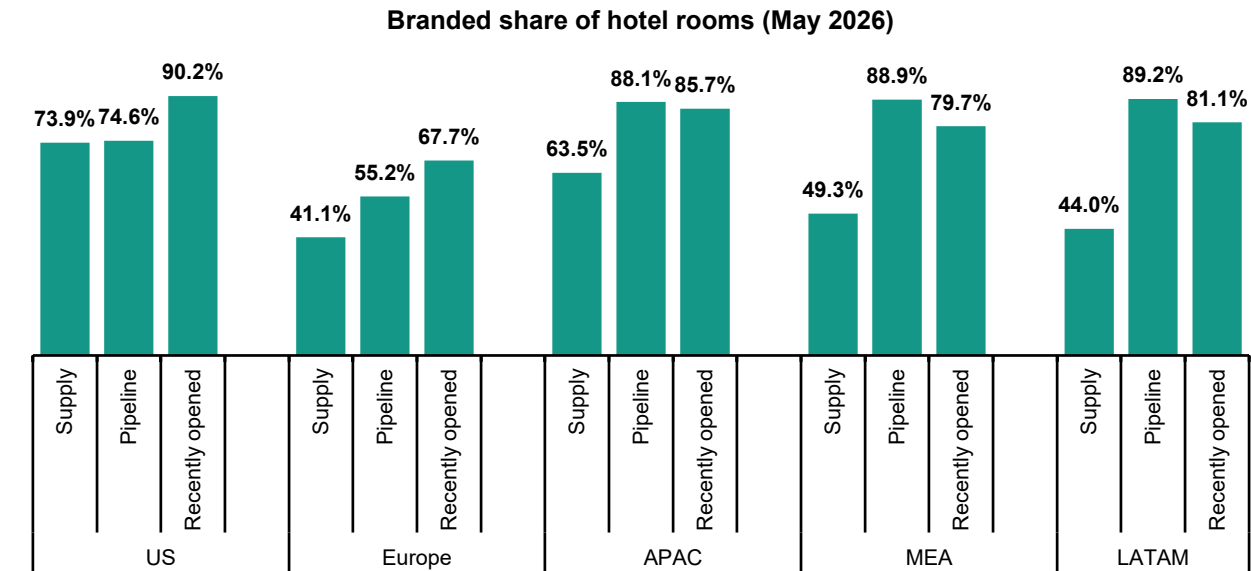
Source: STR, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 57: Hyatt's share of global pipeline stable at ~3.1%



STR tends to understate Hyatt's pipeline
Source: STR, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 58: Brands are taking share in all geographies, most notably in MEA and Latin America



Source: STR, Bernstein analysis

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